

CLAT Express - August 2026: Practice Quizzes

MCQ: +1 for a correct answer, -0.25 for a wrong answer. TITA (type-in-the-answer): +1, no negative marking.

Multiple-choice passages

Ceuta: geography, status and disputes

Ceuta is a small Spanish enclave on the northern coast of Africa. It is bordered on its land side by a neighbouring state, and a strong fence separates the enclave from that country. Many of those who arrive there are seeking work, education or a better life, while others are fleeing conflict or persecution in their home countries. Tensions over a distant territory add another layer to the story. Western Sahara, a former Spanish colony, has been the subject of a long dispute involving neighbouring countries and groups seeking self-determination. Changes in the relations between Spain and its neighbours have, at different times, affected how many people reach the enclave. Ceuta's story shows how geography and politics can combine. A place that is small on the map can become a major point of diplomacy when large numbers of people try to cross into it. Such episodes also test how well the rules protecting people who seek safety are applied in practice.

Q1.

Which body declared the Ceuta Migration Crisis resolved?

- (A) NATO
- (B) United Nations Security Council
- (C) African Union
- (D) European Commission

Q2.

What is the political status of Ceuta?

- (A) Autonomous City of Spain
- (B) French Overseas Territory
- (C) Independent City-State
- (D) UN Trust Territory

Q3.

At the eastern entrance of which strait is Ceuta strategically located?

- (A) Strait of Hormuz
- (B) Bosphorus Strait
- (C) Strait of Malacca
- (D) Strait of Gibraltar

Q4.

According to the booklet, how many land borders does the EU share with Africa?

- (A) One
- (B) Three
- (C) Four
- (D) Two

Q5.

Assertion (A): Fortified border fences separating Ceuta from Morocco are often breached by immigrants.

Reason (R): Ceuta lies on the Atlantic coast of Africa.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q6.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Ceuta's political status	A. 1975
II. Ceuta's neighbouring country	B. 1976
III. Year Morocco annexed Western Sahara	C. Morocco
IV. Year Polisario Front declared SADR	D. Autonomous City of Spain

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-C, II-D, III-B, IV-A
- (B) I-A, II-B, III-C, IV-D
- (C) I-D, II-C, III-A, IV-B
- (D) I-A, II-D, III-C, IV-B

Q7.

Which of the following statements is/are correct?

- I. Ceuta's coast faces the Mediterranean Sea.
- II. Ceuta is an Autonomous City of Spain.
- III. Morocco accepts Spain's sovereignty over Ceuta and Melilla.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and III only
- (B) I and II only
- (C) II and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q8.

Consider the following statements about Ceuta:

- I. It lies on the northern coast of Africa.
- II. It is one of the shortest routes into European territory from Africa.
- III. It lies at the western entrance of the Strait of Gibraltar.

How many of the statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) None

Claims, Law and Disputes

The South China Sea has been a focus of competing territorial claims for many decades. Several countries around its shores assert rights over islands, reefs and surrounding waters, and their claims often overlap. The sea is also rich in resources and fishing grounds, which gives every claimant a practical reason to hold on to the features it controls.

After the Second World War, islands that Japanese forces had used for military purposes became part of the wider question of ownership. Claims were soon drawn on maps, and China's claim is commonly described through a boundary line marked on official maps. That line continued to appear on official maps even after the Chinese Communist Party came to power, and it covers a large share of the sea.

A United Nations convention on the law of the sea sets a legal framework that tries to balance the interests of coastal states and seafaring nations. Although the countries involved have signed and ratified it, its interpretation in this sea remains fiercely disputed. In the early 2000s, ASEAN and China agreed on a declaration meant to manage and resolve disputes.

Disputes have also gone to international bodies. The Philippines brought its case to an arbitral tribunal, arguing that China's claims violated its sovereignty. The tribunal ruled against China, which rejected the ruling and said it preferred bilateral negotiations with the other parties involved. Overlapping claims continue to shape naval activity, fishing and access to resources in the region.

Q1.

Which treaty required Imperial Japan to give up territories it had conquered during World War II?

- (A) Treaty of Nanking
- (B) Treaty of Versailles
- (C) Treaty of Tordesillas
- (D) Treaty of San Francisco (1951)

Q2.

In which year did the UN Convention on the Law of the Sea (UNCLOS) come into force?

- (A) 1947
- (B) 1974
- (C) 2002
- (D) 1994

Q3.

In which year did ASEAN and China sign the Declaration on the Code of Conduct of Parties in the South China Sea?

- (A) 2002
- (B) 2012
- (C) 2013
- (D) 2016

Q4.

Assertion (A): The Philippines took its dispute with China over the South China Sea to the Permanent Court of Arbitration.

Reason (R): The Permanent Court of Arbitration has the power to enforce its rulings.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Permanent Court of Arbitration	A. China has exercised de facto control since 1974
II. UNCLOS	B. Established at The Hague in 1899
III. Scarborough Shoal region	C. Came into force in 1994
IV. Paracel Islands	D. Standoff in 2012 gave China de facto control

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-D, II-C, III-B, IV-A
- (B) I-B, II-C, III-D, IV-A
- (C) I-D, II-B, III-A, IV-C
- (D) I-A, II-D, III-B, IV-C

Q6.

Consider the following statements about the South China Sea:

- I. It is bordered by Taiwan and Brunei, among other countries.
- II. The Luzon Strait connects it with the East China Sea.
- III. UNCTAD estimates that over 21% of global trade passes through it.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and III only
- (B) I and II only
- (C) II and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q7.

How many of the following statements about the Paracel Islands and Scarborough Shoal are correct?

- I. The Paracel Islands are claimed by China, Taiwan and Vietnam.
- II. The Paracel Islands are claimed by Brunei.
- III. The Scarborough Shoal is claimed by the Philippines, China and Taiwan.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only three
- (C) Only two
- (D) None

Q8.

Greater Chinese militarisation of the South China Sea is linked to which broader Chinese initiative?

- (A) Belt and Road land corridor
- (B) String of Pearls
- (C) Digital Silk Road
- (D) Maritime Silk Road

Selection process and straw polls

The United Nations Security Council has held a second round of informal straw polls to help identify a successor to Antonio Guterres, whose second term as Secretary-General is due to end at the close of the year. The selection process begins when the presidents of the General Assembly and the Security Council jointly write to member states, inviting them to put forward candidates. Nominees usually submit a curriculum vitae and a vision statement describing their experience and qualifications. They then take part in interactive dialogues, where they explain their plans for the organisation and answer questions. The straw poll is the next stage. It is an informal and confidential exercise in which Council members show how acceptable each candidate is to them. Because the process runs through successive rounds, weaker candidates can be filtered out over time. Each round gives the Council a clearer picture of which names have broad acceptance among its members, and the process is designed to continue until one candidate has the backing needed. The straw polls are an important stage in narrowing the field, but they are not the final step, since the Council must still formally recommend a candidate before the General Assembly acts.

Q1.

How many UN Member States are invited to nominate candidates?

- (A) 15
- (B) 54
- (C) 100
- (D) 193

Q2.

Which Article of the UN Charter provides for the appointment of the Secretary-General?

- (A) Article 97
- (B) Article 51
- (C) Article 108
- (D) Article 24

Q3.

Assertion (A): A candidate who receives a 'Discourage' from a Permanent Member is likely to advance in the formal vote if at least nine Council members support him or her.

Reason (R): A 'Discourage' indication from a Permanent Member effectively signals that the candidate would face a veto in a formal vote.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q4.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Encourage	A. Used by Permanent Members in subsequent rounds
II. Discourage	B. Member has not taken a position
III. No Opinion	C. Member supports or favours the candidate
IV. Distinctively coloured ballots	D. Member indicates opposition to the candidate

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-A, II-B, III-C, IV-D
- (B) I-C, II-D, III-B, IV-A
- (C) I-B, II-C, III-A, IV-D
- (D) I-C, II-A, III-B, IV-D

Q5.

Consider the following statements about the Security Council's straw polls and selection process:

- I. In subsequent straw poll rounds, Permanent Members use distinctively coloured ballots.
- II. A preferred candidate needs at least 9 of 15 votes and no veto from any Permanent Member.
- III. Straw poll results are binding on the General Assembly's final appointment.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) II and III only
- (B) I and III only
- (C) I and II only
- (D) I, II and III

Q6.

How many of the following statements about the Secretary-General's term are correct?

- I. The UN Charter prescribes a fixed five-year term for the Secretary-General.
- II. Established UN practice provides for a five-year term.
- III. Regional rotation is a legally binding provision of the UN Charter.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) None

Q7.

How many Permanent Members of the 15-member Security Council hold veto power?

- (A) Nine
- (B) Three
- (C) Seven
- (D) Five

Q8.

How many positions can a member indicate in a straw poll?

- (A) Two
- (B) Four
- (C) Five
- (D) Three

Cauvery dispute history check

The Cauvery water dispute is one of the oldest inter-state water conflicts in India, and its roots lie in agreements made long before independence. The disagreement began between the Madras Presidency and the princely state of Mysore. Madras objected when Mysore planned to expand its irrigation and build new water storage structures on the river. A later arrangement allowed Mysore to construct a dam at a village in the region, and that dam later became a major reservoir. The original agreement was meant to operate for a fixed period, and when it came up for review, it became a major source of contention between the successor states. The upper riparian state wants more water for Bengaluru's drinking water and irrigation, while the lower riparian state wants assured releases to support the agriculture of its delta. Because the states could not settle the matter by agreement, the dispute was taken up under the legal framework available for such conflicts. A tribunal was then formed to decide the sharing of water, and its award was later examined by the Supreme Court. Today, a statutory body works to put the final decision into practice, with the help of a regulation committee. Current releases and new projects such as Mokedatu keep the dispute active in public debate.

Q1.

In which year was the Cauvery Water Disputes Tribunal constituted?

- (A) 1990
- (B) 2007
- (C) 1974
- (D) 2018

Q2.

The CWDT Award of 2007 allocated a total of how many TMC of Cauvery water?

- (A) 740 TMC
- (B) 404.25 TMC
- (C) 419 TMC
- (D) 284.75 TMC

Q3.

The 1924 agreement allowed Mysore to construct a dam at Kannambadi village, which led to the development of which dam?

- (A) Mettur Dam
- (B) Mokedatu Dam
- (C) Hemavathi Dam
- (D) Krishnaraja Sagar Dam

Q4.

Assertion (A): The 1924 agreement came up for review after 1974.

Reason (R): The Cauvery Water Disputes Tribunal was constituted in 1990.

- (A) (a) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) (b) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) (c) A is true but R is false
- (D) (d) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Cauvery Water Disputes Tribunal	A. Dam developed under the 1924 agreement
II. Krishnaraja Sagara	B. Aims to supply drinking water to Bengaluru
III. Mekedatu project	C. Major dam in Tamil Nadu
IV. Mettur Dam	D. Constituted in 1990

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-D, II-A, III-B, IV-C
- (B) I-D, II-B, III-A, IV-C
- (C) I-A, II-B, III-C, IV-D
- (D) I-A, II-C, III-B, IV-D

Q6.

Consider the following statements about the Cauvery water sharing awards:

- I. The 2007 award set aside 14 TMC of Cauvery water for environmental purposes.
- II. The 2018 Supreme Court judgment gave Karnataka a larger share than Tamil Nadu.
- III. The 2007 award gave Puducherry 7 TMC of Cauvery water.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q7.

Consider the following statements about the Cauvery dispute:

- I. The 1924 agreement was intended to operate for 50 years.
- II. The Krishnaraja Sagar Dam was developed under the 1892 agreement.
- III. The dispute was brought under Article 262.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) None

Q8.

Apart from Article 262, under which Central Act was the Cauvery dispute brought?

- (A) River Boards Act, 1956
- (B) Water (Prevention and Control of Pollution) Act, 1974
- (C) National Water Policy Act
- (D) Inter-State River Water Disputes Act, 1956

Historical Roots and Current Process

The demand for a separate political or administrative arrangement for the Nepali-speaking Gorkha population of the Darjeeling Hills in West Bengal has a long history. The Gorkhas are people of

Nepali origin, and the term is linked to the historic Gorkha Kingdom of Western Nepal. Political demands for greater autonomy can be traced to the early twentieth century, when the Darjeeling Hillmen's Association petitioned during the Minto-Morley Reforms. Other organisations, including the Gorkha Officers' Association, kept raising demands for greater political autonomy in the years that followed. The Gorkhas also have a distinctive martial tradition, and the British began systematic recruitment of Gorkha soldiers after the Anglo-Nepal War. The movement became far more intense during the 1980s under a new political force. Over time, the movement's objective became clearer in its articulation. More recently, the Ministry of Home Affairs convened a Tripartite Meeting involving the Government of West Bengal and representatives of the Gorkha community. Following that meeting, the Union Government constituted a committee to work out modalities for a Permanent Political Solution. The committee will examine the issue within the Constitutional Framework, including governance arrangements and financial assistance.

Q1.

In 1947, which party submitted a memorandum seeking 'Gorkhasthan' to Jawaharlal Nehru and Liaquat Ali Khan?

- (A) Indian National Congress
- (B) Gorkha National Liberation Front
- (C) Gorkha Officers' Association
- (D) Undivided Communist Party of India

Q2.

Subhas Ghising led which organisation that emerged in 1980 as the principal political force behind the 1980s agitation?

- (A) Gorkha National Liberation Front
- (B) Gorkha Janmukti Morcha
- (C) Darjeeling Gorkha Hill Council
- (D) Kurseong Gorkha Library

Q3.

Assertion (A): Over time, the Gorkha movement articulated its objective as achieving statehood within the Indian Union.

Reason (R): Gorkha demands for political autonomy were first raised only during the 1980s agitation.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q4.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Darjeeling Gorkha Hill Council	A. Led by Subhas Ghising
II. Gorkhaland Territorial Administration	B. Also called Chicken's Neck
III. Siliguri Corridor	C. Created in 2011
IV. Gorkha National Liberation Front	D. Created in 1988

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-D, II-C, III-B, IV-A
- (B) I-C, II-B, III-A, IV-D
- (C) I-C, II-A, III-B, IV-D
- (D) I-A, II-D, III-C, IV-B

Q5.

In which year were Gorkha demands presented before the Simon Commission?

- (A) 1907
- (B) 1980
- (C) 1947
- (D) 1929

Q6.

Which Gorkha ruler played a central role in the unification of Nepal?

- (A) Prithvi Narayan Shah
- (B) Sonam Wangel Laden La
- (C) Subhas Ghising
- (D) Guru Gorakhnath

Amendment and enforcement MCQs

Parliament has passed the Public Examination (Prevention of Unfair Means) Amendment Bill, 2026. The amendment follows the controversy over the NEET-UG 2024 paper leak, in which alleged leak networks were reported to be operating in Patna (Bihar) and Hazaribagh (Jharkhand). Concern grew after 67 candidates secured full marks, aided by disputed grace marks, which triggered nationwide protests and judicial scrutiny. Earlier, Parliament had enacted the Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024. It is India's first dedicated central legislation on question-paper leaks, organised cheating and examination-related fraud. The Act covers major examinations conducted by bodies such as the UPSC, SSC, Railway Recruitment Boards, the National Testing Agency and the Institute of Banking Personnel Selection. The 2026 Amendment is aimed at stronger deterrence. It revises the penalties under four categories: individual offences, service providers, organised examination crime and organised crimes. The penalty for each category differs, so the consequence depends on the category of offence. Demands for stronger deterrence and faster legal proceedings also grew as the controversy continued. The amendment also aims to ensure that examination fraud cases do not remain pending for prolonged periods. It introduces time-bound investigation and trial for offences under the Act. The revised penalties apply to offences under the Act, which covers the examinations listed above.

Q1.

Under the 2026 Amendment, what is the revised punishment for individual offences under the Act?

- (A) 3-5 years + fine up to ₹50 lakh
- (B) Life imprisonment
- (C) 1-2 years + fine up to ₹5 lakh
- (D) 5-10 years + fine up to ₹50 lakh

Q2.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Organised Examination Crime	A. 8-year ban
II. Service Providers	B. 5-10 years + fine up to ₹50 lakh
III. Individual Offences	C. At least 7 years + ₹10 crore fine
IV. Organised Crimes	D. At least 5 years + ₹5 crore fine

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-B, II-A, III-C, IV-D
- (B) I-D, II-B, III-C, IV-A
- (C) I-D, II-C, III-A, IV-B
- (D) I-D, II-A, III-B, IV-C

Q3.

Consider the following statements:

- I. The Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024 is India's first dedicated central legislation on question-paper leaks and exam-related fraud.
- II. The 2026 Amendment gives statutory backing to Fast-Track Courts for trying offences under the Act.
- III. Under the amended Act, appeals before High Courts are heard by a single judge within one month.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and II only
- (D) I, II and III

Q4.

Consider the following statements:

- I. Under the 2026 Amendment, individual offences attract 5-10 years of punishment.
- II. The 11th Finance Commission first recommended Fast Track Courts in 2010.
- III. Appeals before High Courts under the amended Act are disposed of within 6 months.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) None

Q5.

Investigations by which agency, with Supreme Court monitoring, exposed organised cheating syndicates in the NEET-UG 2024 case?

- (A) National Investigation Agency
- (B) Central Bureau of Investigation
- (C) Enforcement Directorate
- (D) Intelligence Bureau

Q6.

Statement I: Under the 2026 Amendment, investigation and trial together are to follow a combined 5-month timeline.

Statement II: Under the 2026 Amendment, the combined timeline for investigation and trial is 6 months.

Which of the statements is/are correct?

- (A) I only
- (B) II only
- (C) Both I and II
- (D) Neither I nor II

Q7.

Which Finance Commission first recommended Fast Track Courts in 2000 to expedite the disposal of long-pending criminal cases?

- (A) 11th Finance Commission
- (B) 10th Finance Commission
- (C) 9th Finance Commission
- (D) 12th Finance Commission

1971 Act and 2026 Bill: CLAT practice

India protects its national symbols through specific laws. The Prevention of Insults to National Honour Act, 1971, is the main law that deals with deliberate insults to the national emblems. It covers the National Flag, the Constitution and the National Anthem, Jana Gana Mana, and it makes certain acts against them punishable. The law describes acts such as burning, defacing or desecrating the flag, and it also covers preventing people from singing the anthem or disturbing a gathering while it is sung. The Act has three main provisions, dealing with the flag and Constitution, the anthem, and repeat offences. The Act was later strengthened so that people who repeat such offences face stricter treatment.

In 2026, the Central Government proposed an amendment to this law in the Rajya Sabha. The Prevention of Insults to National Honour (Amendment) Bill, 2026, aims to extend statutory protection to Vande Mataram, a patriotic song. Under the proposal, intentionally insulting Vande Mataram would become a punishable offence. At present, the Act protects the flag, the Constitution and the anthem, while the amendment seeks to include the National Song, Vande Mataram, within this legal framework. Both the law and the proposed amendment concern national honour.

Q1.

What minimum imprisonment is prescribed under the 1971 Act for a second or subsequent conviction under Section 2 or Section 3?

- (A) No minimum
- (B) 6 months
- (C) 3 years
- (D) 1 year

Q2.

What is the maximum imprisonment prescribed for an offence under Section 2 of the Prevention of Insults to National Honour Act, 1971?

- (A) 3 years
- (B) 1 year
- (C) 6 months
- (D) 7 years

Q3.

Consider the following statements about Vande Mataram:

- I. It was written on 7 November 1875.
- II. Its first public use was at the Varanasi Congress Session in 1905.
- III. It has six stanzas in total.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only three
- (C) None of the above
- (D) Only two

Q4.

Which section of the 1971 Act prohibits intentionally preventing the singing of the National Anthem?

- (A) Section 2
- (B) Section 3A
- (C) Section 1
- (D) Section 3

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Section 2	A. Minimum 1 year imprisonment for repeat convictions
II. Section 3	B. Extends protection to Vande Mataram
III. Section 3A	C. Prohibits insult to the National Flag and Constitution
IV. Bill, 2026	D. Prohibits preventing the singing of the National Anthem

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-C, II-A, III-D, IV-B
- (B) I-C, II-D, III-A, IV-B
- (C) I-B, II-A, III-C, IV-D
- (D) I-D, II-B, III-A, IV-C

Q6.

What punishment has the 2026 Bill proposed for intentionally insulting Vande Mataram?

- (A) Up to 1 year only
- (B) Up to 3 years imprisonment, fine or both
- (C) Life imprisonment
- (D) Fine only, no imprisonment

Q7.

Consider the following statements:

- I. Section 2 prohibits intentional insult to or disrespect for the National Flag and Constitution.
- II. Section 3 prohibits intentionally preventing the singing of the National Anthem.
- III. Section 3A was inserted into the original 1971 Act when it was first enacted.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

National Tribunals Commission: MCQ practice

The Lok Sabha has passed the Tribunals Reforms Bill 2026, which proposes to establish a National Tribunals Commission for unified governance of tribunals. The Bill is intended to replace the Tribunals Reforms Act, 2021, and to restructure the legal framework that governs tribunal appointments and service conditions. It also re-enacts provisions of the 2021 law that were struck down, and it is drafted in line with the Supreme Court's directions on judicial independence and separation of powers. The Supreme Court has repeatedly examined provisions that gave the Executive excessive control over tribunals, including in *Madras Bar Association v. Union of India*. The proposed Commission would provide a common institutional framework for all tribunals covered under the Bill. Its major functions include selecting tribunal chairpersons and members, reviewing the performance of members, overseeing complaints and disciplinary inquiries, and providing administrative supervision. It will also maintain a national tribunals data grid. For selection, a Search-cum-Selection Committee will recommend candidates for each vacancy. The Commission framework applies to a wide range of bodies, from central and state administrative tribunals to specialised bodies such as the Armed Forces Tribunal and the National Consumer Disputes Redressal Commission. The Central Government will frame the rules governing service conditions. Reappointment for another term is considered on the basis of past performance.

Q1.

What minimum relevant experience must the Technical Members of the National Tribunals Commission have?

- (A) 15 years
- (B) 20 years
- (C) 30 years
- (D) 25 years

Q2.

Within what time must the Central Government complete the appointment process after receiving an NTC recommendation?

- (A) 3 months
- (B) 1 month
- (C) 6 months
- (D) 1 year

Q3.

Assertion (A): The Search-cum-Selection Committee of the NTC recommends candidates for each vacancy.

Reason (R): The Central Government must complete the appointment process within three months of receiving the recommendation.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q4.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Age cap for NTC Chairpersons	A. Five years
II. Age cap for NTC Members	B. 70 years
III. Maximum term for NTC Chairpersons and Members	C. 16
IV. Tribunals and authorities covered by the framework	D. 67 years

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-C, II-B, III-D, IV-A
- (B) I-D, II-C, III-B, IV-A
- (C) I-C, II-D, III-B, IV-A
- (D) I-B, II-D, III-A, IV-C

Q5.

Consider the following statements about the National Tribunals Commission:

- I. The Judicial Members must be Chief Justices or Judges of a High Court.
- II. The Chairperson must be a Judge of the Supreme Court or a Chief Justice of a High Court.
- III. Reappointment of members is decided by the Central Government alone, without consulting the Tribunal Chairperson.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q6.

Consider the following statements about the National Tribunals Commission framework:

- I. Chairpersons are capped at 70 years of age.
- II. Members are capped at 70 years of age.
- III. Terms are capped at five years, or the age limit if earlier.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only three
- (C) Only two
- (D) None

Q7.

Which of the following bodies is included among the tribunals covered under the proposed framework?

- (A) Supreme Court of India
- (B) Election Commission of India
- (C) High Court of Delhi
- (D) National Green Tribunal

Q8.

How many Judicial Members does the National Tribunals Commission have, apart from the Chairperson?

- (A) 1
- (B) 3
- (C) 4
- (D) 2

Components, targets and priority basins

India imports a large part of the crude oil and natural gas it uses, and policymakers have long wanted more of this supply to come from within the country. Much of the unexplored potential lies beneath the sea, in deep and far-off waters where drilling is costly and technically demanding. Companies hesitate to commit money to such projects because results can take years to arrive. At the same time, the fields that already produce oil and gas do not stay productive forever. Their output falls every year as the reservoirs age, so new discoveries are needed just to keep production steady.

The Samudra Manthan Scheme is the government's response to this problem. It is built around several linked streams of work. Some streams focus on locating resources and on drilling in difficult waters. Others focus on shared facilities that can move produced oil and gas, on building a domestic base of manufacturing and services, and on developing skills and technology. The plan also sets a clear quantity goal, aiming to add a large volume of reserves and to raise annual domestic output. Taken together, the scheme hopes to reduce risk for investors, strengthen national capability, and make India less reliant on imported energy in the years ahead.

Q1.

Under the Samudra Manthan Scheme, what is the target for adding reserves?

- (A) Over 600 MMTOE
- (B) Over 300 MMTOE
- (C) Over 900 MMTOE
- (D) Over 1200 MMTOE

Q2.

By how much is annual domestic oil and gas production targeted to rise under the scheme?

- (A) From 40 to 60 MMTOE
- (B) From 80 to 100 MMTOE
- (C) From 100 to 120 MMTOE
- (D) From 62 to 80 MMTOE

Q3.

What is the target for expanding India's resource base under the scheme?

- (A) From 1.6 billion to 2.2 billion tonnes of oil equivalent
- (B) From 1 billion to 1.5 billion tonnes of oil equivalent
- (C) From 2 billion to 3 billion tonnes of oil equivalent
- (D) From 0.5 billion to 1 billion tonnes of oil equivalent

Q4.

Assertion (A): The scheme offers government risk-sharing to attract private investment into offshore projects.

Reason (R): Offshore exploration involves high financial and technological risks.

- (A) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (B) A is true but R is false
- (C) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Seismic exploration	A. Accelerated drilling in deepwater and frontier basins
II. Exploratory drilling	B. Shared production and evacuation infrastructure
III. Common infrastructure	C. Integrated oil and gas manufacturing and services zone
IV. Manufacturing & services	D. Acquisition, processing and interpretation of seismic data

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-B, II-D, III-C, IV-A
- (B) I-D, II-A, III-B, IV-C
- (C) I-B, II-A, III-C, IV-D
- (D) I-D, II-A, III-C, IV-B

Q6.

Which of the following statements about the scheme is/are correct?

- I. The implementation period runs up to FY 2030-31.
- II. Government support covers up to 75% of eligible drilling costs.
- III. Krishna-Godavari Basin is among the priority offshore regions.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q7.

How many of the following statements about the scheme are correct?

- I. The scheme is classified as a State Sector Scheme.
- II. A deepwater exploratory well can cost approximately \$125-150 million.
- III. Existing oil and gas fields face production declines of around 6-7% annually.

How many of the statements are correct?

- (A) Only three
- (B) Only one
- (C) Only two
- (D) None

Q8.

Which of the following is NOT listed as a priority offshore region under the scheme?

- (A) Krishna-Godavari Basin
- (B) Cauvery Basin
- (C) Mahanadi Basin
- (D) Rann of Kutch Basin

Sarnath: inscription, sites and sermon

Sarnath, a Buddhist site in Uttar Pradesh, has recently been inscribed on the UNESCO World Heritage List. The inscription was made at a meeting of the World Heritage Committee, and it raised the total number of such sites in India. Sarnath holds a special place in Buddhist history because Gautama Buddha gave his first teaching there after attaining enlightenment at Bodhgaya. The event marks the beginning of the Buddhist monastic community, known as the Sangha, and it is linked with the Noble Eightfold Path. The site was known in earlier times by several names, and it is visited today for its monuments. Visitors see the Chaukhandi, Dhamekh and Dharmarajika stupas, a vihara and the Ashokan Pillar. Many of these structures are linked with episodes from the Buddha's life or with rulers of the past. Sarnath is also counted among the principal Buddhist pilgrimage sites. India has many heritage sites of different kinds, grouped as cultural, natural and mixed. Each category holds its own set of monuments, and together they show how varied the country's heritage is. The process of recognition involves assessment by expert bodies before the final decision is taken by the committee.

Q1.

During which session of the World Heritage Committee was Sarnath inscribed, and in which city was it held?

- (A) 46th session, New Delhi
- (B) 47th session, Riyadh
- (C) 49th session, Paris
- (D) 48th session, Busan (Republic of Korea)

Q2.

After Sarnath's inscription, how many UNESCO World Heritage Sites does India have in total?

- (A) 45
- (B) 48
- (C) 40
- (D) 42

Q3.

What is the name of the event when Gautama Buddha gave his first sermon at Sarnath?

- (A) Dharmachakra Pravartana
- (B) Mahaparinirvana
- (C) Sambodhi
- (D) Nirvana Chakra

Q4.

Assertion (A): The Ashokan Pillar at Sarnath carries a Lion Capital.

Reason (R): The Lion Capital is India's National Emblem.

Select the correct option.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Chaukhandi Stupa	A. Buddha's first sermon
II. Dhamekh Stupa	B. Buddha's rainy-season retreat
III. Dharmarajika Stupa	C. Meeting of Buddha and his first five disciples
IV. Mulagandhakuti Vihara	D. Emperor Ashoka and Buddha's relics

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-D, II-C, III-A, IV-B
- (B) I-C, II-A, III-D, IV-B
- (C) I-B, II-A, III-C, IV-D
- (D) I-A, II-B, III-C, IV-D

Q6.

Consider the following statements about Sarnath:

- I. Sarnath is one of the four principal Buddhist pilgrimage sites.
- II. The Chaukhandi Stupa marks the site of Buddha's first sermon.
- III. The Dharmarajika Stupa is traditionally associated with Emperor Ashoka and Buddha's relics.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q7.

How many of the following statements are correct?

- I. Dholavira is the only Indus Valley Civilization site from India on the World Heritage List.
- II. Khangchendzonga National Park is India's mixed heritage site.
- III. The Mulagandhakuti Vihara marks the site of Buddha's first sermon.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) None

Q8.

Which of the following is NOT an ancient name for Sarnath?

- (A) Rishipatana
- (B) Ishipatana
- (C) Mrigadava
- (D) Kushinagar

UNCCD and COP17 Recall

The 17th round of talks under the United Nations Convention to Combat Desertification recently concluded in Ulaanbaatar, the capital of Mongolia. The meeting coincided with a United Nations

observance that draws attention to pastoral communities and the management of rangelands, which are grasslands and open lands used for grazing. The emphasis on pastoral communities reflects how directly their livelihoods depend on the condition of the land. Land degradation was a central concern. It is described as a serious threat to ecosystems, farming, the availability of water and the economic stability of many regions. The crisis affects a large share of the world's land, and delegates argued that restoring whole landscapes is more effective than scattered, isolated projects. Mongolia used the platform to explain the severity of its own problem, and it has a national campaign to plant trees over the coming years. Several countries also promoted nature-based solutions and ecosystem restoration as part of national development planning. The convention itself is a legally binding framework dealing with desertification, land degradation and drought, and its work connects closely with climate and biodiversity agreements. Its broader aim is sustainable land management, so that land continues to support people and nature.

Q1.

How many of the following statements about the UNCCD and COP17 are correct?

- I. The Convention came into force in December 1996.
 - II. Its core objective includes achieving Land Degradation Neutrality by 2030.
 - III. India is not a Party to the Convention.
 - IV. The theme of COP17 was 'Land for Life'.
- (A) Only one
 - (B) Only two
 - (C) Only three
 - (D) All four

Q2.

Consider the following statements about the UNCCD:

- I. The Convention is one of three Rio Conventions.
- II. Egypt will host UNCCD COP 18 in Sharm El-Sheikh in 2028.
- III. India is not a Party to the Convention.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q3.

Read the assertion and reason.

Assertion (A): Mongolia's 'Billion Trees' campaign aims to plant 1 billion trees by 2030.

Reason (R): Land degradation is a major threat to ecosystems, agriculture, water availability and economic stability.

Choose the correct option.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q4.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Land Degradation Neutrality (LDN)	A. One of three Rio Conventions
II. UNCCD membership	B. Land resources remain stable or improve
III. UNCCD as one of the Rio Conventions	C. Adopted on 17 June 1994 (World Day to Combat Desertification)
IV. UNCCD adoption date	D. 197 Parties, including 196 countries and the EU

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-D, II-B, III-C, IV-A
- (B) I-B, II-A, III-D, IV-C
- (C) I-A, II-D, III-C, IV-B
- (D) I-B, II-D, III-A, IV-C

Q5.

Approximately what percentage of the world's land surface is affected by the land degradation crisis?

- (A) 20%
- (B) 30%
- (C) 60%
- (D) 40%

Q6.

Approximately what percentage of Mongolia's territory is affected by land degradation?

- (A) 77%
- (B) 60%
- (C) 45%
- (D) 90%

Q7.

Which country will host UNCCD COP 18 in 2028?

- (A) Mongolia
- (B) India
- (C) Saudi Arabia
- (D) Egypt

Q8.

Which of the following is the principal decision-making body of the UNCCD?

- (A) Conference of the Parties
- (B) Business4Land Initiative
- (C) Drought Resilience Investment Facility
- (D) Riyadh Global Drought Resilience Partnership

Global Tiger Day MCQ set

Wild tigers live in a number of countries across Asia, and Global Tiger Day is an occasion to focus attention on their survival. Governments and conservation groups treat the animal as a shared responsibility, because a tiger that roams across borders cannot be protected by one country alone. The international effort is organised around the countries where wild tigers still live, which are called Tiger Range Countries. These nations meet in summits and sign common documents that describe their aims. The programmes described for this region cover habitat restoration, measures against poaching and cooperation with local communities who live close to forests. A central idea in recent observances is coexistence, meaning that people and tigers should be able to share the same landscape. The campaign also stresses that solutions must be scaled up so that they reach

many forests, not only a few protected areas. In India, the tiger is the national animal, and the country has a legal framework that governs how tiger reserves are created and protected. Public awareness is therefore as important as government action, since many tiger habitats are shared with local communities. Together, these efforts show that the future of the tiger depends on policy, science and the daily choices of people who share its habitat.

Q1.

On which date is Global Tiger Day observed annually?

- (A) 22 July
- (B) 5 August
- (C) 15 September
- (D) 29 July

Q2.

Global Tiger Day was established at which summit?

- (A) 2010 St. Petersburg Tiger Summit, Russia
- (B) 2005 Bangkok Wildlife Summit
- (C) 2015 Delhi Tiger Conference
- (D) 2019 Kathmandu Tiger Forum

Q3.

How many Tiger Range Countries adopted the St. Petersburg Declaration?

- (A) 8
- (B) 10
- (C) 12
- (D) 13

Q4.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Target year of the TX2 goal	A. 1973
II. Year Global Tiger Day was celebrated to bolster international efforts	B. 2022
III. International Big Cat Alliance launched	C. 2010
IV. Jim Corbett, first Tiger Reserve set up	D. 2023

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-C, II-D, III-B, IV-A
- (B) I-D, II-B, III-C, IV-A
- (C) I-B, II-C, III-D, IV-A
- (D) I-D, II-A, III-B, IV-C

Q5.

Consider the following statements:

- I. Global Tiger Day was established at the 2010 St. Petersburg Tiger Summit.
- II. Twelve Tiger Range Countries adopted the St. Petersburg Declaration.
- III. The TX2 motto represents the goal of doubling the global tiger population by 2022.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I, II and III
- (D) I and III only

Q6.

How many of the following statements are correct?

- I. IUCN observes Global Tiger Day.
 - II. The TX2 goal aimed to triple the tiger population by 2025.
 - III. Thirteen Tiger Range Countries adopted the St. Petersburg Declaration.
- (A) Only one
 - (B) Only two
 - (C) Only three
 - (D) None of the above

Q7.

Which of these is named among the Tiger Range Countries in the booklet?

- (A) Vietnam
- (B) Kenya
- (C) Brazil
- (D) Canada

Glaw Lake and Ramsar Basics

Glaw Lake, a lake in the Eastern Himalayas, has recently gained recognition as a wetland of global importance. It lies in Arunachal Pradesh, and its waters are fresh rather than salty. The lake sits within a protected area. The recognition came under the Ramsar Convention, the intergovernmental treaty on wetlands. It is the only international treaty that addresses one specific ecosystem. Under this treaty, wetlands of international importance are declared as Ramsar sites. The term wetland is broad. It describes any area of land covered by water, whether that water is salt, fresh or somewhere in between, and whether it is present seasonally or permanently. Wetland types include rivers, swamps, wet grasslands, peatlands, deltas and tidal flats, as well as mangroves and coral reefs. The treaty has been in force for decades and has many member states. Glaw Lake's recognition is an example of a wider expansion of India's protected wetlands network. India has steadily added sites to its Ramsar network over the years. India also runs a National Wetland Conservation Program, implemented through state authorities. Government schemes also support this work. One scheme focuses on the optimal use of wetlands, and its aims include enhancing biodiversity, carbon stock and income for local communities. Another focus is moving from high-volume tourism to nature tourism at ecologically sensitive wetlands.

Q1.

Glaw Lake is India's which Ramsar Site, by number?

- (A) 75th
- (B) 88th
- (C) 110th
- (D) 101st

Q2.

In which protected area is Glaw Lake situated?

- (A) Kamlang Tiger Reserve and Wildlife Sanctuary
- (B) Namdapha National Park
- (C) Pakke Tiger Reserve
- (D) Mouling National Park

Q3.

Assertion (A): Glaw Lake is a freshwater wetland in the Eastern Himalayas.

Reason (R): Ramsar wetlands are found only in freshwater lakes and rivers.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is false but R is true
- (D) A is true but R is false

Q4.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Montreux Record	A. Notified in 2017
II. Wetland City Accreditation Program	B. Joint effort of Ministry of Tourism and MoEFCC
III. Amrit Dharohar Capacity Building Scheme	C. Validity of 6 years
IV. Wetlands (Conservation and Management) Rules	D. Launched in 1990

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-B, II-A, III-D, IV-C
- (B) I-D, II-C, III-B, IV-A
- (C) I-D, II-B, III-C, IV-A
- (D) I-A, II-D, III-B, IV-C

Q5.

Consider the following statements about Glaw Lake:

- I. It is a pristine freshwater lake.
- II. It lies in the Eastern Himalayas region.
- III. It is a coastal wetland of the salt-water type.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and III only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I, II and III
- (D) I and II only

Q6.

How many of the following statements about the Montreux Record are correct?

- (a) It was launched in 1990.
 - (b) It identifies Ramsar sites that need priority conservation attention.
 - (c) Chilka Lake is currently listed in it.
- (A) Only one
 - (B) None
 - (C) Only two
 - (D) Only three

Q7.

Which Indian state has the maximum number of Ramsar sites?

- (A) Tamil Nadu
- (B) Rajasthan
- (C) West Bengal
- (D) Odisha

Glasgow 2026 at a glance: CLAT-style MCQs

The 2026 edition was staged in Glasgow and brought together athletes from the nations and territories of the Commonwealth. The Games are organised by the Commonwealth Games Federation, and the event has a long history that began with a sporting competition held in London in 1911. Glasgow had hosted the event once before, in 2014, so the city has welcomed the Games previously. The programme for 2026 covered a wide range of disciplines, including athletics, swimming, cycling, weightlifting, boxing and judo. Teams from many countries took part, although not every nation entered every discipline. India's contingent included para athletes, and its medal count was reported at the close of the event. Indian women boxers were among the standout performers of the event, and several of them won gold medals. At the closing ceremony, India's flag

was carried by boxer Jaismine Lamboria, who had won a gold medal in the women's 57 kg category. Medal tallies are widely reported, and they are a common way to compare how countries performed across the event.

Q1.

Read the assertion and reason.

Assertion (A): The 23rd Commonwealth Games were held in Glasgow, Scotland.

Reason (R): Neeraj Chopra won silver in the men's javelin throw at Glasgow 2026.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q2.

Which city will host the 2030 Commonwealth Games?

- (A) Ahmedabad
- (B) New Delhi
- (C) Glasgow
- (D) Edinburgh

Q3.

How many of the following statements about Glasgow 2026 are correct?

- A. The Games were held in Scotland.
 - B. India fielded a netball team.
 - C. Judo was one of the sports featured.
 - D. Cricket was one of the sports featured.
- (A) Only one
 - (B) Only two
 - (C) Only three
 - (D) None

Q4.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Mascot of Glasgow 2026	A. 74
II. Nations and territories	B. 10
III. Sports featured at Glasgow 2026	C. Ahmedabad
IV. Host of the 2030 Commonwealth Games	D. Finnie

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-A, II-B, III-D, IV-C
- (B) I-C, II-D, III-B, IV-A
- (C) I-B, II-C, III-D, IV-A
- (D) I-D, II-A, III-B, IV-C

Q5.

How many nations and territories took part in Glasgow 2026?

- (A) 74
- (B) 54
- (C) 65
- (D) 82

Q6.

How many sports were featured at Glasgow 2026?

- (A) 8
- (B) 12
- (C) 19
- (D) 10

Q7.

What is the name of the mascot of Glasgow 2026?

- (A) Finnie
- (B) Clyde
- (C) Brodie
- (D) Hamish

Q8.

Consider the following statements about Glasgow 2026:

- I. The Games featured 10 sports.
- II. India fielded teams in 3x3 Basketball and Netball.
- III. The mascot Finnie was inspired by Scotland's National Animal.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Flag, freedom and the navy

The national flag of India took shape over several decades of the freedom struggle. Pingali Venkayya, a freedom fighter from Andhra Pradesh, worked on flag designs and is remembered for his role in the Indian Tricolour. At the 1921 session of the Indian National Congress held at Vijayawada, he presented a khadi flag design to Mahatma Gandhi. His first design had red and green bands, with a charkha at the centre, representing the two major communities. On Gandhi's suggestion, a white band was added to stand for peace, while the charkha was kept as a symbol of self-reliance. In 1931, the Congress formally adopted a modified tricolour, which became the precursor of the present flag. The Constituent Assembly adopted the present National Flag on 22 July 1947, and it became the national flag of independent India on 15 August 1947.

The freedom movement also reached the armed forces. In 1946, Indian naval ratings rose against British authorities in several port cities, demanding better food, pay comparable with the Royal Navy, and an end to the use of Indian personnel for British imperial expansion. The uprising drew support from workers, students and civilians. Its anti-colonial mood was shaped in part by the legacy of the Indian National Army trials.

Symbols and protests of this period show how closely ideas of unity, peace and self-reliance were linked with the struggle for independence.

Q1.

On which date did the Royal Indian Navy Mutiny of 1946 begin at HMIS Talwar in Bombay?

- (A) 15 August 1947
- (B) 22 July 1947
- (C) 18 February 1946
- (D) 2 August 1876

Q2.

Which Article of the Constitution mandates respect for the national flag and anthem?

- (A) Article 51A(a)
- (B) Article 19(1)(c)
- (C) Article 43B
- (D) Part IXB

Q3.

How many spokes does the Ashoka Chakra on the national flag have?

- (A) 12
- (B) 16
- (C) 21
- (D) 24

Q4.

Assertion (A): The white band on the national flag represents peace and truth.

Reason (R): Flag or anthem offences lead to a 6-year election ban under the National Honour Act.

In the light of the above statements, choose the correct option.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Ashoka Chakra	A. Fertility and growth
II. Green colour on the flag	B. Governs display and use of the flag
III. First flag hoisted in Kolkata (1907)	C. Navy blue wheel with 24 spokes
IV. Flag Code of India	D. Red, yellow and green stripes with Vande Mataram

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-C, II-A, III-D, IV-B
- (B) I-B, II-D, III-C, IV-A
- (C) I-A, II-D, III-B, IV-C
- (D) I-D, II-A, III-C, IV-B

Q6.

Consider the following statements:

I. Venkayya met Mahatma Gandhi during the 2nd Boer War (1899-1902).

II. Venkayya authored The Mother of Diamonds in 1921.

III. All India Radio Vijayawada was renamed in his honour in 2015.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q7.

Consider the following statements about the Royal Indian Navy Mutiny of 1946:

- I. It spread to Karachi, Visakhapatnam, Jamnagar and Kolkata.
- II. Rebels organised themselves under a Naval Strike Committee.
- III. One of its demands was the withdrawal of British Indian troops from Indonesia.
- IV. It began at HMIS Talwar in Karachi.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only three
- (C) Only two
- (D) All of the above

Q8.

The Royal Indian Navy Mutiny of 1946 was partly shaped by the legacy of the INA trials and which leader?

- (A) Mahatma Gandhi
- (B) Prasanta Chandra Mahalanobis
- (C) Pingali Venkayya
- (D) Subhas Chandra Bose

Dirac Medal: award check

The Dirac Medal is an annual award that honours the legacy of the renowned physicist Paul Dirac. Dirac is remembered as one of the founders of modern quantum mechanics, and the medal carries his name. In 2026, the medal was awarded to the physicist Deepak Dhar, who shared the honour with three other physicists. The recognition was given for pioneering work in statistical mechanics, the field in which their research lies. Each recipient of the award receives a medal, which marks the honour in a tangible form. The award is given every year, and the 2026 medal is the latest of these presentations. Readers preparing for competitive examinations should keep the winners, the field of the work and the namesake of the award together while revising. Knowing the namesake links the medal to the history of quantum mechanics, and knowing the field helps in identifying the 2026 work. This item appears in the AILET Corner of the August 2026 current affairs section. Each of the details above is part of the same award, so revising them together helps in keeping the item clear in memory.

Q1.

In which year was the Dirac Medal instituted?

- (A) 1933
- (B) 2026
- (C) 1995
- (D) 1985

Q2.

How many of the following statements are correct?

- I. The Dirac Medal was instituted in 1985.
 - II. The medal is presented by the International Centre for Theoretical Physics.
 - III. The medal is named after Erwin Schrödinger.
- (A) Only one
 - (B) Only two
 - (C) Only three
 - (D) None

Q3.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Year the Dirac Medal was instituted	A. International Centre for Theoretical Physics
II. Cash prize per recipient	B. 1933
III. Body that presents the medal	C. 1985
IV. Year Dirac received the Nobel Prize	D. US\$5,000

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-C, II-A, III-D, IV-B
- (B) I-B, II-D, III-C, IV-A
- (C) I-C, II-D, III-A, IV-B
- (D) I-A, II-B, III-D, IV-C

Q4.

Deepak Dhar, the 2026 recipient, is a physicist from which country?

- (A) United States
- (B) Germany
- (C) India
- (D) Israel

Q5.

Which international body presents the Dirac Medal?

- (A) International Centre for Theoretical Physics
- (B) International Atomic Energy Agency
- (C) Royal Society of London
- (D) Nobel Foundation

Q6.

Consider the following statements about Paul Dirac:

- I. Dirac received the 1933 Nobel Prize in Physics.
- II. Dirac shared the 1933 Nobel Prize with Erwin Schrödinger.
- III. Dirac shared the 2026 Dirac Medal with Deepak Dhar.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q7.

Which of the following did NOT share the 2026 Dirac Medal?

- (A) Bernard Derrida
- (B) Haim Sompolinsky
- (C) Deepak Dhar
- (D) Erwin Schrödinger

Refugees, Asylum Seekers and Migrants

The booklet separates three groups of people on the move: refugees, asylum seekers and migrants. Each group differs in the reason for moving, the protection it can receive and the law that governs its stay. A refugee is a person who is forced to flee because of persecution or conflict, and refugee status is recognised under an international framework that sets guidelines for host countries. An asylum seeker is a person who seeks recognition as a refugee, so a formal decision on the claim is still to come. A migrant, by contrast, moves mainly for work, education or better opportunities rather than to escape danger. The booklet also refers to several other international instruments

that concern people on the move, including one that protects children and one based on the Universal Declaration of Human Rights. The categories also appear in the booklet's coverage of the Ceuta Migration Crisis, in which nearly 60000 migrants attempted to enter the Spanish enclave from Morocco in July 2026. Refugees, asylum seekers and migrants are all people on the move, but the booklet treats each category as distinct in law. The three terms are presented in a simple layout, with a short list of features under each heading.

Q1.

According to the booklet, which principle prohibits the forcible return of refugees?

- (A) Non-refoulement
- (B) Principle of reciprocity
- (C) Doctrine of sovereign immunity
- (D) Principle of proportionality

Q2.

Which category of people does the booklet say does not qualify for refugee status?

- (A) Persons fleeing armed conflict
- (B) Asylum seekers awaiting a decision
- (C) War criminals
- (D) Migrants seeking work

Q3.

Who receives temporary protection during the application process, according to the booklet?

- (A) Refugees
- (B) Migrants
- (C) War criminals
- (D) Asylum seekers

Q4.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. 1967 Protocol	A. Advocates for refugee children's welfare
II. Global Compact on Refugees	B. Affirms the right to seek asylum from persecution
III. Convention on the Rights of the Child	C. Framework to support refugees and host countries
IV. Article 14 of the UDHR	D. Removed geographic and time limits on refugee protection

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-D, II-C, III-A, IV-B
- (B) I-B, II-C, III-A, IV-D
- (C) I-B, II-C, III-D, IV-A
- (D) I-A, II-B, III-C, IV-D

Q5.

Consider the following statements:

- I. Refugees are protected under the 1951 Refugee Convention.
- II. Asylum seekers are governed mainly by domestic immigration laws.
- III. Refugees can be forcibly returned if their home state requests it.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) II and III only
- (B) I and II only
- (C) I only
- (D) I, II and III

Q6.

How many of the following statements are correct?

- I. Asylum seekers are awaiting a decision on their refugee status.
 - II. Migrants are protected under the 1951 Refugee Convention.
 - III. Migrants move mainly to escape persecution.
- (A) Only two
 - (B) Only one
 - (C) Only three
 - (D) All of the above

Spanish Territories and the Regional Dispute

Spain exercises sovereignty over these territories, which the booklet describes as exclaves. Ceuta lies on the northern coast of Africa, on the Mediterranean Sea. Its neighbour is Morocco, and the booklet reports that nearly 60000 migrants attempted to enter the enclave from that country in July 2026. The booklet also places Ceuta within a wider regional picture that includes Western Sahara. That territory, described as a former Spanish colony, has been the subject of competing proposals and claims for many years. Several governments and movements have taken positions on its future, and the booklet records some of them. Ceuta is also described in the booklet as one of the shortest routes into European territory from Africa. Melilla, too, is one of the Spanish territories that the booklet names. The booklet names each territory in turn and then turns to the wider dispute. The booklet's coverage of this topic appears in its current affairs section for August 2026, under the heading International Relations and News. The booklet also states that the crisis was declared resolved through cooperation between Spain and Morocco.

Q1.

Which group has demanded self-determination for the Sahrawi people?

- (A) Spanish Crown
- (B) Moroccan Royal Council
- (C) Algerian Army
- (D) Polisario Front

Q2.

Which country disputes the status of Ceuta, Melilla and the Plazas de Soberania?

- (A) Algeria
- (B) Portugal
- (C) Morocco
- (D) France

Q3.

Which issue does the booklet closely link to the Western Sahara dispute?

- (A) Migration through Ceuta
- (B) Oil pipelines in the Sahara
- (C) Fishing rights off Melilla
- (D) Tourism in the Canary Islands

Q4.

Assertion (A): Migration flows through Ceuta have been influenced by changes in Spain's relations with Morocco and Algeria.

Reason (R): Spain's relations with Morocco and Algeria have repeatedly changed over time.

Choose the correct option.

- (A) A is false but R is true
- (B) A is true but R is false
- (C) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (D) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Polisario Front	A. Former Spanish colony annexed by Morocco in 1975
II. Western Sahara	B. Proposes autonomy under its sovereignty
III. Algeria	C. Declared the Sahrawi Arab Democratic Republic in 1976
IV. Morocco	D. Supports the Polisario Front

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-B, II-A, III-C, IV-D
- (B) I-D, II-C, III-A, IV-B
- (C) I-C, II-A, III-D, IV-B
- (D) I-A, II-D, III-B, IV-C

Q6.

Consider the following statements:

- I. Algeria proposes autonomy under its sovereignty for Western Sahara.
- II. Melilla is located on the Atlantic coast of Europe.
- III. The Polisario Front demands self-determination for the Sahrawi people.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) III only
- (B) I and II only
- (C) II and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q7.

How many of the following statements are correct?

- I. Western Sahara was annexed by Morocco in 1975.
- II. The Polisario Front declared the Sahrawi Arab Democratic Republic in 1975.
- III. Algeria proposes autonomy under its sovereignty for Western Sahara.

- (A) Only two
- (B) Only one
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

UNHCR, Its Origins and Indian Law

The United Nations High Commissioner for Refugees, known as UNHCR, is the UN body that works for refugees. It was formed in December 1950 as a successor to an earlier organisation that was set up after the Second World War. The idea behind the post is older. The UNHCR's stated aim is to protect the rights of people fleeing conflict and persecution and to ensure a better future for them. The organisation has received the Nobel Peace Prize twice. The booklet also notes that World Refugee Day falls on June 20 and that its 2026 theme is Until Everyone Is Safe. On the same page, the booklet moves from the Refugee Convention and other treaties to a section on UNHCR. The booklet also refers to the International Covenant on Civil and Political Rights, which safeguards individuals from torture or inhuman treatment upon return. In India, the booklet explains that undocumented foreigners are regulated under several older statutes. The booklet has a separate section on UNHCR's history and awards, which sits under the heading United Nations High Commissioner for Refugees. Its coverage of these topics appears in the current affairs section for August 2026.

Q1.

Which award honours exceptional service to refugees, displaced or stateless people each year?

- (A) Indira Gandhi Prize
- (B) Nobel Peace Prize
- (C) UNHCR Nansen Refugee Award
- (D) Global Refugee Forum Award

Q2.

Where are the headquarters of UNHCR located?

- (A) New York
- (B) Paris
- (C) Geneva
- (D) Bonn

Q3.

Which organisation did UNHCR succeed?

- (A) International Refugee Organization
- (B) League of Nations
- (C) UN Security Council
- (D) International Criminal Court

Q4.

Assertion (A): The Passport (Entry into India) Act is one of the Acts that regulate undocumented foreigners in India.

Reason (R): The Citizenship Act was enacted in 1955.

Choose the correct option.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) A is true but R is false
- (C) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Fridtjof Nansen	A. Formed on 14 December 1950
II. UNHCR	B. Enacted in 1920
III. Registration of Foreigners Act	C. Led the refugee office that originated under the League of Nations in 1921
IV. Passport (Entry into India) Act	D. Enacted in 1939

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-D, II-B, III-A, IV-C
- (B) I-C, II-D, III-A, IV-B
- (C) I-D, II-B, III-C, IV-A
- (D) I-C, II-A, III-D, IV-B

Q6.

Consider the following statements:

- I. The Nansen Refugee Award is presented by the League of Nations.
- II. UNHCR has received the Nobel Peace Prize in 1954 and 1981.
- III. UNHCR has received the Indira Gandhi Prize in 2015.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) I and III only
- (C) II and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q7.

How many of the following statements are correct?

- I. The Nansen Refugee Award honours exceptional service to refugees, displaced or stateless people.
- II. The Registration of Foreigners Act was enacted in 1955.
- III. The Citizenship Act was enacted in 1955.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Where the Sea Lies

The South China Sea lies in the Pacific region, alongside the mainland of South-East Asia. Several countries border its waters, and the sea is linked to neighbouring seas through passages at its edges. The sea lies within a maritime zone that is heavily trafficked, and a large portion of global trade moves through this zone every year. Its waters hold oil and gas deposits beneath the seabed, and they also support rich fishing grounds. Because of these resources and routes, the sea has become a focus of attention for the states around it. Its waters have also been the subject of long-running disputes, and many of these disputes concern islands scattered across the sea. Several of the islands are claimed by more than one state. International law provides a legal framework that seeks to balance the interests of coastal states and seafaring nations, though its interpretation in this sea remains fiercely disputed. Ships that move through these waters follow routes shaped by the passages at the sea's edges. In short, the sea is important for commerce, resources and regional security. The islands and waters at its centre have drawn repeated attention from governments in the region. This makes the sea a subject of continuing diplomatic effort.

Q1.

Which of the following countries is listed among those bordering the South China Sea?

- (A) Thailand
- (B) Brunei
- (C) Japan
- (D) Cambodia

Q2.

Through which strait is the South China Sea linked with the Philippine Sea?

- (A) Malacca Strait
- (B) Taiwan Strait
- (C) Sunda Strait
- (D) Luzon Strait

Q3.

Which sea does the Taiwan Strait connect the South China Sea with?

- (A) East China Sea
- (B) Philippine Sea
- (C) Java Sea
- (D) Arabian Sea

Q4.

Read the following assertion and reason.

Assertion (A): The South China Sea and the East China Sea together are termed the China Sea.

Reason (R): The Luzon Strait links the South China Sea with the East China Sea.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Taiwan Strait	A. Philippine Sea
II. Luzon Strait	B. China Sea
III. South China Sea and East China Sea	C. Arm of the Western Pacific Ocean
IV. South China Sea	D. East China Sea

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-C, II-D, III-B, IV-A
- (B) I-D, II-B, III-C, IV-A
- (C) I-A, II-D, III-B, IV-C
- (D) I-D, II-A, III-B, IV-C

Q6.

Read the following statements about the sea's geography:

- I. The Taiwan Strait links the sea with the East China Sea.
- II. Thailand is among the countries bordering the sea.
- III. Brunei is among the countries bordering the sea.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q7.

How many of the following statements about the sea's geography are correct?

- I. The sea is an arm of the Western Pacific Ocean.
- II. Japan is among the countries bordering the sea.
- III. The Luzon Strait connects the sea with the East China Sea.

- (A) Only two
- (B) All of the above
- (C) Only one
- (D) Only three

Resources and Trade of the Sea

The South China Sea contains deposits of oil and natural gas beneath its seabed, and those deposits have been estimated by a United States government agency. The sea is part of a heavily

trafficked maritime zone, and a large share of global trade moves through this zone. Ships crossing the sea carry goods between many ports, and the traffic on these routes is substantial. Because the sea holds resources and routes of this kind, it is a place of economic interest for the states around it. Several islands in the sea are claimed by more than one state, and the booklet notes that these claims overlap. Its waters have also been the subject of long-running disputes, which involve questions of energy, fishing and the rights of coastal states. Estimates of its resources are published figures, and they are presented as estimates rather than as certain amounts. Taken together, these features explain why the sea is discussed so often in international news. The sea's resources and routes therefore matter to the countries around it, and the disputes over its waters continue to shape how it is used.

Q1.

According to the US Energy Information Agency, how much oil is estimated to lie in deposits under the sea?

- (A) 12 billion barrels
- (B) 190 billion barrels
- (C) 11 billion barrels
- (D) 3.37 trillion barrels

Q2.

Which agency estimated that over 21% of global trade passes through the sea?

- (A) US Energy Information Agency
- (B) Permanent Court of Arbitration
- (C) World Bank
- (D) UNCTAD

Q3.

What does the booklet say about the sea's fishing vessels?

- (A) More than half of the world's fishing vessels operate in this area
- (B) About one-fifth of the world's fishing vessels operate in this area
- (C) None of the world's fishing vessels operate in this area
- (D) Fishing vessels are banned from the area

Q4.

Read the following assertion and reason.

Assertion (A): Ships passing through the sea add to its importance for global commerce.

Reason (R): Nearly one-third of the world's shipping trade passes through this waterway each year.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Estimated oil deposits under the sea	A. 190 trillion cubic feet
II. Estimated natural gas deposits	B. Over 21%
III. Share of the world's fisheries	C. 11 billion barrels
IV. Share of global trade (UNCTAD)	D. 12%

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-C, II-B, III-A, IV-D
- (B) I-C, II-A, III-D, IV-B
- (C) I-C, II-D, III-A, IV-B
- (D) I-D, II-A, III-C, IV-B

Q6.

Read the following statements about the sea's resources and trade:

- I. The estimated oil deposits under the sea are 11 billion barrels.
- II. The estimated natural gas deposits under the sea are 190 billion cubic feet.
- III. Nearly one-third of the world's shipping trade passes through the sea each year.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) I and III only
- (C) II and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q7.

How many of the following statements about the sea's fishing and trade are correct?

- I. The sea's fishing grounds are estimated to hold 12% of the world's fisheries.
- II. UNCTAD estimates that over 21% of global trade passes through the sea.
- III. The sea lies within the Indian Ocean.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only three
- (C) Only two
- (D) All of the above

Islands and Claims

Several islands and shoals in the South China Sea are claimed by more than one country, and many of these claims overlap. The Paracel Islands are one such group, and they lie in an area where a battle once took place. One larger island group is claimed by a bigger number of states than most other features in the sea, which makes it central to the disputes. Scarborough Shoal is another feature whose ownership is contested by several governments. Control of these features is not settled, and the claimant states have taken different positions on how the disputes should be resolved. The booklet notes that China has preferred bilateral negotiations with the other parties involved, and it records that China asserts historical rights to the sea. The overlapping claims shape the way the sea is governed, and each state's position affects the others. The claims are not only about land but also about the waters that surround each feature. The booklet also describes what these disputes mean for states beyond the region. Regional stability and freedom of navigation are central themes in this debate. These claims have been pursued over a long period, which is why the disputes are described as long-running.

Q1.

Which island group is claimed by China, Taiwan, Vietnam, Brunei and the Philippines?

- (A) Paracel Islands
- (B) Pratas Islands
- (C) Spratly Islands
- (D) Scarborough Shoal

Q2.

Read the following assertion and reason.

Assertion (A): India has a stake in the security of the South China Sea.

Reason (R): A significant share of India's maritime commerce passes through the South China Sea and the Malacca Strait.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q3.

A 2012 standoff gave China de facto control over which region?

- (A) Paracel Islands
- (B) Spratly Islands
- (C) Pratas Islands
- (D) Scarborough region

Q4.

How many of the following statements about India's interests in the sea are correct?

- I. Greater Chinese militarisation could threaten the security of Sea Lines of Communication.
- II. Chinese naval infrastructure in the sea could facilitate greater Indian Ocean power projection.
- III. The Spratly Islands are claimed by India.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Q5.

Read the following statements about the island claims:

- I. The Paracel Islands are claimed by China, Taiwan and Vietnam.
- II. Brunei is among the claimants of the Paracel Islands.
- III. China has exercised de facto control of the Scarborough region since 1974.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I only
- (B) I and II only
- (C) II and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q6.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Paracel Islands	A. Security could be threatened by greater Chinese militarisation
II. Spratly Islands	B. Claimed by the Philippines, China and Taiwan
III. Scarborough Shoal	C. Claimed by China, Taiwan, Vietnam, Brunei and the Philippines
IV. Sea Lines of Communication	D. Claimed by China, Taiwan and Vietnam

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-C, II-B, III-D, IV-A
- (B) I-D, II-A, III-B, IV-C
- (C) I-D, II-C, III-B, IV-A
- (D) I-C, II-A, III-B, IV-D

Q7.

China has exercised de facto control of the Paracel Islands since 1974, following a battle involving which country?

- (A) Taiwan
- (B) South Vietnam
- (C) The Philippines
- (D) Brunei

Straw Polls and Permanent Member Signals

The Security Council has held a second round of informal straw polls to identify a potential successor to Antonio Guterres. His second term as UN Secretary-General is scheduled to conclude on 31 December 2026, so the selection is taking place as that date approaches. Straw polls form one stage in narrowing the field before the Council formally recommends a candidate to the United Nations General Assembly. Nominees also take part in interactive dialogues with Member States, where they discuss their vision for the United Nations and respond to questions from stakeholders. During a straw poll, each Council member records a position on each candidate. The polls are not the final decision, because the Council's recommendation is one part of a longer procedure that is completed when the General Assembly acts on it. Guterres's term is the reason the process is taking place now, and the Council must work through each stage before a recommendation can be made. The booklet presents this as a key stage in the process, one that comes before any decision taken by the General Assembly.

Q1.

What does an Encourage indication mean in a straw poll?

- (A) The member opposes the candidate
- (B) The member supports or favours the candidate
- (C) The member has not taken a position
- (D) The member is requesting more nominees

Q2.

What is the purpose of straw polls?

- (A) Formal appointment of the Secretary-General
- (B) Selecting the host country for UN headquarters
- (C) Finalising the budget of the Secretary-General's office
- (D) Assessing the relative acceptability of candidates

Q3.

Until when do straw poll rounds continue?

- (A) A fixed number of three rounds
- (B) Until the General Assembly intervenes
- (C) Until a candidate demonstrates sufficient support
- (D) Until the outgoing Secretary-General approves

Q4.

Consider the following statements about straw polls:

- I. Straw polls are formal and binding votes.
- II. Members may indicate Encourage, Discourage or No Opinion.
- III. Permanent Members use distinctively coloured ballots in every round.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II only
- (C) I, II and III
- (D) II and III only

Q5.

How many of the following statements about straw polls are correct?

- I. Straw polls are held only once before the Council recommends a candidate.
 - II. No Opinion means the member has not taken a position.
 - III. A Discourage from a Permanent Member means the candidate has been formally appointed.
- (A) All of the above
 - (B) Only two
 - (C) Only one
 - (D) Only three

Q6.

What do nominees typically submit as part of the nomination process?

- (A) Curriculum vitae and vision statements
- (B) A signed treaty
- (C) A financial disclosure form
- (D) A letter of recommendation only

UNSC Structure and the Veto

The Council is responsible for maintaining international peace and security, and it is among the principal organs of the United Nations. The booklet describes the Council as the apex of that structure, which places it at the centre of the organisation's work. Its membership is arranged so that different members have different roles. Permanent Members have a distinct place in the Council, and the booklet treats their position as central to how decisions are reached. The booklet argues that the Council's structure has not kept pace with the present world. It also connects the Council's current shape to the period in which the Council was created. For the Council to act on a matter, the arrangements that govern its decisions must allow a decision to pass, and the booklet examines whether those arrangements still serve the present international order. The discussion is therefore about how the Council is built, who sits in it, and how its decisions can be stopped or carried forward.

Q1.

What happens when a single Permanent Member opposes a proposal?

- (A) The decision passes if a majority supports it
- (B) A unanimous vote of all UN members is needed
- (C) The decision is blocked regardless of other support
- (D) The matter is referred automatically to the ICJ

Q2.

Assertion (A): The UNSC was powerless during the Russia-Ukraine conflict.

Reason (R): Russia used its veto as a Permanent Member.

- (A) Both A and R are true, and R explains A
- (B) Both A and R are true, but R does not explain A
- (C) A is true, but R is false
- (D) A is false, but R is true

Q3.

Consider the following statements about the UN Security Council:

- I. Each of the 15 members has one vote.
- II. Non-permanent members hold veto power.
- III. The General Assembly holds the veto power.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) I only
- (C) II and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q4.

How many of the following statements about the Security Council are correct?

- I. The veto system is seen as a tool that can block progress in the UN.
- II. A majority of members can override a Permanent Member's objection.
- III. The five Permanent Members hold veto power.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only three
- (C) Only two
- (D) All of the above

Q5.

Why did the five Permanent Members gain permanent membership?

- (A) They were the largest economies in the world
- (B) They won the Second World War
- (C) They founded the League of Nations
- (D) They were elected by the General Assembly

Q6.

Can a retiring Council member be re-elected immediately?

- (A) Yes, automatically
- (B) Yes, but only with a Permanent Member's vote
- (C) Yes, after a single term out of office
- (D) No, it is not eligible for immediate re-election

Q7.

The UNSC is one of how many principal organs of the UN?

- (A) Four
- (B) Five
- (C) Seven
- (D) Six

Cauvery River and its basin: Practice MCQs

The Cauvery is a river at the centre of a long-running dispute among the states that share its waters. The dispute has historical roots in an agreement between the Madras Presidency and the princely state of Mysore. Madras objected when Mysore planned to expand irrigation and to construct water storage structures on the river. The river later became a major source of contention between the successor states. Karnataka is the upper riparian state, and it seeks greater water availability for drinking water in Bengaluru city and for irrigation. Tamil Nadu is the lower riparian state, and it seeks assured releases of water for agriculture in the Cauvery delta. To understand the dispute, it helps to know some basic facts about the river itself. The Cauvery's drainage basin is divided into an upper part and a lower part. Several major dams have been built on the river, and the states through which it passes share its waters. The dispute was taken up at the national level, where it was brought under the Constitution and a central law. A tribunal was later constituted to hear the dispute, and its award allocated water among the states concerned. Taken together, these facts show why the river has remained at the centre of the dispute.

Q1.

The Cauvery River is also known as the:

- (A) Ganga of the South
- (B) Ganga of the East
- (C) Nile of India
- (D) Amazon of the South

Q2.

How many of the following statements about the Cauvery are correct?

- I. The Cauvery originates in Kodagu district of Karnataka.
 - II. Mettur Dam is located in Tamil Nadu.
 - III. The Cauvery's Upper Basin is located in Tamil Nadu.
- (A) Only one
 - (B) Only two
 - (C) Only three
 - (D) All of the above

Q3.

Assertion (A): The Cauvery drains into the Arabian Sea.

Reason (R): The Cauvery is an east-flowing Peninsular River.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q4.

Near which place does the Cauvery drain into the Bay of Bengal?

- (A) Rameswaram
- (B) Poompuhar
- (C) Chennai
- (D) Nagapattinam

Q5.

Consider the following statements about the Cauvery River:

- I. The Cauvery's drainage basin covers Kerala and Puducherry.
- II. The Cauvery originates in the Nilgiri Hills of Tamil Nadu.
- III. The Cauvery is known as the Ganga of the East.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I only
- (B) I and II only
- (C) II and III only
- (D) I and III only

Q6.

Which major dam on the Cauvery is located in Karnataka?

- (A) Mettur Dam
- (B) Mekedatu Balancing Reservoir
- (C) Krishna Raja Sagara
- (D) Hemavathi Dam

Q7.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Upper Basin	A. Karnataka
II. Lower Basin	B. Talakaveri
III. Origin of the Cauvery	C. Southwest Monsoon
IV. Krishna Raja Sagara	D. Northeast Monsoon

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-C, II-A, III-D, IV-B
- (B) I-B, II-C, III-A, IV-D
- (C) I-C, II-D, III-B, IV-A
- (D) I-A, II-C, III-D, IV-B

Mekedatu project and the latest order: Practice MCQs

The Cauvery dispute is shaped by the positions of the states along the river. Karnataka lies upstream as the upper riparian state, while Tamil Nadu lies downstream as the lower riparian state. Karnataka has sought greater availability of water for its own needs, and Tamil Nadu has sought assured releases of water for agriculture in the Cauvery delta. The dispute has a long history, going back to an agreement of 1892 between the Madras Presidency and the princely state of Mysore. Madras objected when Mysore planned to expand irrigation and build storage

structures on the river. In the present phase, two developments have drawn attention. A regulatory body on the river has endorsed an order concerning the release of water from Karnataka to Tamil Nadu. Separately, Karnataka has put forward the Mekedatu Balancing Reservoir Project on the Cauvery River. Projects of this kind can affect how much water flows downstream to the lower riparian state. The river also has several major dams, which are part of the water system the states share. The sections above describe the states' positions, the historical agreement, and the two developments that have drawn attention to the dispute. Taken together, these points show why any new step on the river is examined closely in relation to the flow of water to Tamil Nadu.

Q1.

Which body endorsed the order directing Karnataka to release water to Tamil Nadu?

- (A) Cauvery Water Regulation Committee
- (B) Cauvery Water Management Authority
- (C) Central Water Commission
- (D) Cauvery Water Disputes Tribunal

Q2.

How many Cusecs of Cauvery water did the order direct Karnataka to release to Tamil Nadu?

- (A) 2,500 Cusecs
- (B) 3,000 Cusecs
- (C) 5,000 Cusecs
- (D) 3,500 Cusecs

Q3.

What does the Mekedatu project aim to provide to Bengaluru city?

- (A) Drinking water
- (B) Irrigation for delta farms
- (C) Flood control in Kodagu
- (D) Fish farming

Q4.

Assertion (A): Tamil Nadu has opposed the Mekedatu Balancing Reservoir Project.

Reason (R): Tamil Nadu is the upper riparian state on the Cauvery.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Consider the following statements about the Mekedatu project:

- I. The project aims to generate power.
- II. Tamil Nadu raised objections to the project in 2020.
- III. Tamil Nadu opposes projects in the upper riparian region unless they receive Supreme Court approval.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q6.

How many of the following statements about the order and the project are correct?

- I. The order directs Karnataka to release water to Tamil Nadu.
 - II. The Mokedatu project aims to supply irrigation water to the Cauvery delta.
 - III. Tamil Nadu approached the Supreme Court in 2018 over the Mokedatu project.
- (A) Only one
 - (B) Only three
 - (C) Only two
 - (D) All of the above

Identity and Demand Bases

The Gorkhaland issue concerns a demand for a separate political or administrative arrangement for the Gorkha population of the Darjeeling Hills in West Bengal. Supporters of the movement say that the people of the hills have their own language, culture and social character, and that these set them apart from the wider population of the state. Much of the case therefore rests on the idea of a distinct identity. Beyond identity, the movement has raised questions of dignity and representation. Such concerns have been present for a long time, and they continue to shape how the debate is framed. Economic concerns form a second strand of the argument. Demands for greater control over decisions and public money are closely tied to these grievances. Supporters also point out that the region contributes to the state's economy through its natural and commercial activities. The movement has a long history. Its early political demands can be traced to the start of the twentieth century, and the agitation that followed gave the movement great momentum. Today the discussion centres on how governance, finance and development should be organised for the hill region within the existing constitutional system.

Q1.

The Darjeeling Hills population is described as having a distinct linguistic, cultural and social identity compared with which group?

- (A) Nepali-majority hill districts
- (B) Bengali-majority plains
- (C) Assamese-majority valley
- (D) Hindi-speaking central belt

Q2.

Besides political autonomy, the demand for Gorkhaland also raises concerns about insufficient which kind of autonomy?

- (A) Judicial autonomy
- (B) Military autonomy
- (C) Fiscal autonomy
- (D) Religious autonomy

Q3.

Concerns over identity insecurity and which other factor have contributed to demands for stronger political recognition and representation?

- (A) Religious discrimination
- (B) Language ban
- (C) Border disputes
- (D) Racial stereotyping

Q4.

Assertion (A): The Gorkhaland demand is based only on identity considerations.

Reason (R): Economic concerns such as infrastructure and employment are also part of the case for greater recognition.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Predominant language of the hill region	A. Darjeeling Tea, Forestry and Tourism
II. Institution giving greater autonomy to the hill region	B. Nepali
III. Sector cited as a regional contribution	C. Inadequate infrastructure
IV. Long-standing economic concern	D. Darjeeling Gorkha Hill Council

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-C, II-D, III-B, IV-A
- (B) I-B, II-D, III-A, IV-C
- (C) I-D, II-C, III-B, IV-A
- (D) I-D, II-A, III-B, IV-C

Q6.

Statements:

- I. The Darjeeling Hills population is described as having a distinct linguistic identity.
- II. Proponents seek separation of the community from India.
- III. Concerns over identity insecurity have contributed to demands for stronger political recognition and representation.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and III only
- (B) I and II only
- (C) II and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q7.

Statements:

Statement 1: The region has a predominantly Nepali-speaking population.

Statement 2: Proponents seek separation of the community from India.

Statement 3: The region contributes through Darjeeling Tea, Forestry and Tourism.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only three
- (B) Only one
- (C) Only two
- (D) All of the above

Talks, Committee and Challenges

Talks on the Gorkhaland question have entered a new phase. A meeting involving the state government and representatives of the Gorkha community was held recently, and the Union Government then set up a committee to take the matter forward. The committee has been asked to prepare an agreement and to lay out the steps needed for a lasting settlement.

The committee will look at the issue in light of the country's basic law. Its scope covers how the region should be governed, the financial support it receives and the development programmes that can be pursued. It will also work on a roadmap for several Gorkha communities to receive a special category of recognition.

Not everyone agrees on the path ahead. In parts of the state there is opposition to any division of territory, and those who hold this view are concerned about the unity of the state and the smooth working of its administration. The political landscape is also crowded, since the Gorkha side is represented by several organisations, which makes a shared stand hard to reach.

The region's location adds weight to the issue. Long unrest in the hills could affect more than local life, because the area lies in a sensitive position that matters for the wider country. The local economy depends heavily on plantations and visitors, and it faces difficulties that shift with the seasons and with longer trends. Any new arrangement would need a sound economic base to survive.

Q1.

Which ministry of the Union Government convened the recent Tripartite Meeting on the Gorkhaland issue?

- (A) Ministry of Tribal Affairs
- (B) Ministry of Home Affairs
- (C) Ministry of External Affairs
- (D) Ministry of Panchayati Raj

Q2.

Within which framework will the committee examine the Gorkhaland issue?

- (A) International Framework
- (B) Judicial Framework only
- (C) Constitutional Framework
- (D) Military Framework

Q3.

What critical function does the Siliguri Corridor serve for India?

- (A) Principal land link between mainland India and the Northeast
- (B) Sole international airport route
- (C) Main coastal trade route
- (D) Route connecting Delhi and Mumbai

Q4.

Assertion (A): The Gorkha political landscape is dominated by a single organisation.

Reason (R): Multiple Gorkha organisations make it difficult to agree on a common position.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Countries close to the Darjeeling region	A. Structural and seasonal economic challenges
II. Group making a common position difficult	B. Administrative cohesion
III. Concern behind opposition to territorial division	C. Gorkha Janmukti Morcha
IV. Economic sustainability challenge	D. Nepal, Bhutan and Bangladesh

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-A, II-D, III-B, IV-C
- (B) I-D, II-C, III-B, IV-A
- (C) I-A, II-B, III-D, IV-C
- (D) I-B, II-A, III-C, IV-D

Q6.

Statements:

- I. Opposition in parts of West Bengal to territorial division reflects concerns over territorial integrity.
- II. Prolonged instability in the region has only local implications for tea production.
- III. The regional economy depends on tea, tourism and related activities, which face structural and seasonal challenges.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q7.

Statements:

Statement 1: The Union Government constituted a committee to work out modalities for a Permanent Political Solution.

Statement 2: The Siliguri Corridor lies close to Nepal, Bhutan and Bangladesh.

Statement 3: The committee's work will be limited to the number of Lok Sabha seats in the state.

Statement 4: The committee will examine the issue within the Constitutional Framework.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only three
- (B) Only two
- (C) All of the above
- (D) Only one

NEET-UG 2024 leak and the 2024 Act: MCQ practice

The NEET-UG 2024 controversy drew national attention after a paper leak was alleged in the examination. Alleged leak networks were reported in Patna and Hazaribagh, and the case showed how a question paper could be compromised before the test was held. Both places were linked to these alleged networks. Candidates in the examination were affected, and the controversy drew attention across the country. A group of candidates secured full marks, and the way those results were produced became a key point of dispute. Investigations later exposed organised cheating syndicates that had worked to compromise the examination process. Monitoring by the Supreme Court kept the case under close watch while the investigations continued. In response, Parliament passed the Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act in 2024. The Act applies to major public examinations, including tests held by national-level recruitment and testing bodies. It is

meant to deal with paper leaks, organised cheating and other forms of fraud connected with examinations. The law was therefore passed after the controversy had exposed these problems. The Act was thus a legal answer to the problems that the NEET-UG case had revealed. Its title shows that its focus is on unfair means in public examinations.

Q1.

Which bodies' examinations are covered by the Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024?

- (A) Only NEET and JEE
- (B) Only state public service commissions
- (C) UPSC, SSC, Railway Recruitment Boards, National Testing Agency and Institute of Banking Personnel Selection
- (D) Only private universities

Q2.

What aided the full-marks outcome in NEET-UG 2024 that intensified the controversy?

- (A) Disputed grace marks
- (B) Re-evaluation of answer sheets
- (C) Extra time given to candidates
- (D) A revised answer key issued by a court

Q3.

Alleged leak networks in the NEET-UG 2024 case were reported in which two states?

- (A) Delhi and Haryana
- (B) Odisha and West Bengal
- (C) Rajasthan and Gujarat
- (D) Bihar and Jharkhand

Q4.

Assertion (A): The Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024 was India's first state-level law on paper leaks.

Reason (R): The Act is described as India's first dedicated central legislation on paper leaks, organised cheating and exam-related fraud.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) A is false but R is true
- (C) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (D) A is true but R is false

Q5.

I. Parliament has passed an amendment to the Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act in 2026.

II. The full-marks outcome in NEET-UG 2024 was not connected to grace marks.

III. The full-marks outcome triggered nationwide protests and judicial scrutiny.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and III only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and II only
- (D) I, II and III

Q6.

How many of the following statements are correct?

- I. The NEET-UG paper leak controversy of 2026 intensified demands for stronger deterrence and faster legal proceedings.
 - II. The Act was enacted before the NEET-UG 2024 paper leak occurred.
 - III. The Act was enacted in 2026.
- (A) Only two
 - (B) Only three
 - (C) Only one
 - (D) All of the above

Q7.

How many candidates secured full marks in NEET-UG 2024?

- (A) 25
- (B) 45
- (C) 100
- (D) 67

Special Task Force and task force reforms: MCQ practice

The Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024 followed a controversy over the NEET-UG 2024 examination, in which alleged paper leaks were reported in Patna and Hazaribagh. A group of candidates secured full marks in the same examination, and the outcome led to protests across the country. Investigations and monitoring by the Supreme Court followed. The Act is described as India's first dedicated central legislation on paper leaks, organised cheating and exam-related fraud. The Act covers major public examinations, including those conducted by UPSC and SSC. It includes a provision for a Special Task Force that can be set up to investigate offences under the law. Such a force is meant for specialised investigation and is linked to the Act's enforcement. The government has also constituted a high-powered task force to look into examination matters at a broader level. The high-powered task force is a separate body from the Special Task Force. The 2026 amendment, which Parliament has passed, adds further provisions to the framework created by the 2024 Act. The controversy that preceded the Act was widely followed, and the new provisions respond to demands for faster legal proceedings. Alleged leaks were the subject of investigation, and the NEET-UG case remained a reference point for the debate on examination fraud.

Q1.

How many of the following statements are correct?

- I. The Special Task Force is particularly relevant to organised criminal syndicates.
 - II. The Special Task Force is particularly relevant only to offences committed within a single state.
 - III. Nandan Nilekani is a Co-Founder of Wipro.
- (A) Only one
 - (B) Only two
 - (C) Only three
 - (D) All of the above

Q2.

- I. The Union Government is empowered to establish a Special Task Force for investigating offences under the Act.
- II. The high-powered task force is chaired by Nandan Nilekani.
- III. The Special Task Force is set up mainly to drive strategic policy reforms.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I, II and III
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and II only
- (D) I and III only

Q3.

The Special Task Force is particularly relevant to which kind of networks?

- (A) Inter-state paper-leak networks
- (B) Election funding networks
- (C) Cyber fraud networks in banks
- (D) Customs duty evasion networks

Q4.

Nandan Nilekani is the Founding Chairman of which authority?

- (A) Food Safety and Standards Authority of India
- (B) Securities and Exchange Board of India
- (C) National Human Rights Commission
- (D) Unique Identification Authority of India

Q5.

Nandan Nilekani is a Co-Founder of which company?

- (A) Wipro
- (B) Infosys
- (C) Tata Consultancy Services
- (D) HCL Technologies

Q6.

Assertion (A): The high-powered task force was constituted to investigate individual offences under the Act.

Reason (R): The high-powered task force was constituted under Nandan Nilekani's chairmanship to drive strategic policy reforms.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) A is false but R is true
- (C) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (D) A is true but R is false

Q7.

Which authority is empowered to establish the Special Task Force under the Act?

- (A) State Governments
- (B) Supreme Court of India
- (C) National Testing Agency
- (D) Union Government

National Song and National Anthem: Status and Protection

India recognises two songs in connection with its national identity: the National Anthem, Jana Gana Mana, and the National Song, Vande Mataram. The two songs do not hold identical positions. Jana Gana Mana is the National Anthem. Vande Mataram was given the status of National Song after independence.

Respect for national symbols is also linked to the duties of citizens. The fundamental duties in the Constitution ask every citizen to respect the National Flag and the National Anthem. Parliamentary practice gives the anthem a ceremonial role as well, because sittings of Parliament begin with it.

Existing legislation already protects the National Flag and the Constitution from intentional insult or disrespect, and acts such as burning, defacing or desecrating the flag are covered. The anthem also receives statutory protection, which makes it an offence to intentionally prevent its singing or to disturb an assembly during its rendition.

A 2026 amendment proposal would extend this framework to Vande Mataram. Intentionally insulting the song, or obstructing its singing, would become punishable, placing it within the same legal framework that protects the anthem. The stated objective is to give Vande Mataram statutory protection similar to the protection the anthem currently has. The anthem's existing protection is therefore the model for the proposed change, which would apply the same offences to a second national symbol.

Q1.

On what date did Dr. Rajendra Prasad declare Vande Mataram the National Song of India?

- (A) 15 August 1947
- (B) 26 January 1950
- (C) 24 January 1950
- (D) 7 August 1905

Q2.

Under which Article of the Constitution are the fundamental duties to respect the National Flag and National Anthem listed?

- (A) Article 14
- (B) Article 51A
- (C) Article 370
- (D) Article 1

Q3.

Which existing statute already protects the National Anthem from intentional disruption?

- (A) Constitution of India
- (B) Ninth Schedule
- (C) Prevention of Insults to National Honour Act, 1971
- (D) Parliamentary protocol

Q4.

Read the assertion and reason and choose the correct option.

Assertion (A): The Constitution of India explicitly recognises a National Song.

Reason (R): Vande Mataram was given the status of National Song after independence.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Vande Mataram	A. Goddess Durga
II. Jana Gana Mana	B. Town Hall, Calcutta
III. First public use on 7 August 1905	C. Composed by Rabindranath Tagore
IV. Goddess imagery in Vande Mataram	D. Written by Bankim Chandra Chattopadhyay

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-B, II-C, III-A, IV-D
- (B) I-D, II-C, III-B, IV-A
- (C) I-D, II-B, III-A, IV-C
- (D) I-B, II-D, III-A, IV-C

Q6.

Consider the following statements about the national songs:

- I. The entire text of Jana Gana Mana has official recognition.
- II. Parliamentary sittings are closed sine die with Vande Mataram.
- III. Vande Mataram is at present protected under the 1971 Act.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I only
- (B) II only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I and II only

Q7.

Consider the following statements regarding the two songs:

- I. Vande Mataram was to be honoured equally with the National Anthem.
- II. Parliamentary sittings are closed sine die with the National Anthem.
- III. Vande Mataram was composed by Rabindranath Tagore.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Tribunals and Ordinary Courts

Tribunals are quasi-judicial bodies whose basic aim is to adjudicate specialised disputes and to reduce the workload of constitutional courts. They operate in areas such as taxation, company law, environment, telecommunications, armed forces and administrative matters. The Income Tax Appellate Tribunal, established in 1941, is described as the first tribunal in India, and it was set up to reduce court workload, expedite adjudication of disputes and build expertise on tax matters. The Lok Sabha has passed the Tribunals Reforms Bill 2026, which seeks to establish a National Tribunals Commission for unified tribunal governance. The Bill is meant to replace the Tribunals Reforms Act 2021. The proposed commission would handle the selection of tribunal chairpersons and members, performance review of members, oversight of complaints and administrative supervision. Tribunal decisions remain subject to scrutiny by the concerned High Court. The National Green Tribunal aims at giving relief and compensation for environmental damage, and it works on the polluter pays principle and sustainable development. It hears civil cases under seven laws and is guided by the principles of natural justice. Its decisions can be executed as a decree of a civil court. The Bill also proposes a national tribunals data grid, which is one of the commission's major functions.

Q1.

According to the booklet, what kind of body is an Administrative Tribunal?

- (A) A court established directly by the Constitution
- (B) A branch of a High Court
- (C) An agency created by statute that derives its powers from the State
- (D) A private arbitration panel

Q2.

Which quality is described as a crucial requirement for judges in a court of law?

- (A) Political affiliation
- (B) Impartiality
- (C) Advanced age
- (D) Prior service in the Executive

Q3.

Civil courts possess judicial authority over which category of suits?

- (A) Only suits involving the Government
- (B) Suits of a criminal nature only
- (C) All suits without any exception
- (D) Suits of a civil nature, unless barred by law

Q4.

Assertion (A): An Administrative Tribunal may be a party to a dispute that it decides.

Reason (R): Tribunals have power to try special cases defined by Statutes.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Judges in ordinary courts	A. Required to be trained in law
II. Administrative Tribunal members	B. Expert in administrative matters
III. Presiding officer of a court	C. Entirely controlled by the Executive
IV. Tribunal President or member	D. Independent regarding tenure, terms and conditions of service

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-D, II-C, III-A, IV-B
- (B) I-A, II-C, III-B, IV-D
- (C) I-C, II-B, III-D, IV-A
- (D) I-B, II-A, III-C, IV-D

Q6.

Consider the following statements about courts and tribunals:

- I. Tribunals have power to try special cases defined by Statutes.
- II. The tenure of Administrative Tribunal members is controlled by the judiciary.
- III. A President or Member of a tribunal must always be legally trained.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) II and III only
- (B) I and III only
- (C) I only
- (D) I, II and III

Q7.

Consider the following statements about courts and tribunals:

1. Judges in ordinary courts are independent regarding tenure, terms and conditions of service.
2. Impartiality is not a requirement for judges in a court of law.
3. Civil courts have judicial authority over all suits, including those barred by law.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Constitutional Framework for Tribunals

Tribunals in India are bodies that adjudicate specialised disputes, and they are meant to reduce the workload of constitutional courts. Their work spans many fields, including taxation, company law, environment, telecommunications, armed forces and administrative matters. Tribunal decisions remain subject to scrutiny by the concerned High Court. The National Green Tribunal aims at giving relief and compensation for environmental damage, and it works on the polluter pays principle and sustainable development. It hears civil cases under seven laws and is guided by the principles of natural justice. Its decisions can be executed as a decree of a civil court. The Lok Sabha has passed the Tribunals Reforms Bill 2026, which seeks to establish a National Tribunals Commission for unified tribunal governance. The Bill seeks to replace the Tribunals Reforms Act 2021, and it deals with the selection of tribunal chairpersons and members, performance review of members and maintaining a national tribunals data grid. The Supreme Court's role is reflected in *Madras Bar Association v. Union of India* (2010-2025), which repeatedly scrutinised certain provisions relating to tribunals. Such scrutiny has focused on provisions that give the Executive excessive control over tribunals. The Bill also contains the re-enactment of provisions that were struck down earlier.

Q1.

Which amendment inserted Part XIV-A into the Constitution?

- (A) 44th Amendment
- (B) 52nd Amendment
- (C) 42nd Constitutional Amendment Act, 1976
- (D) 61st Amendment

Q2.

Which pair of Articles is contained in Part XIV-A?

- (A) Articles 323A and 323B
- (B) Articles 226 and 227
- (C) Articles 32 and 226
- (D) Articles 124 and 125

Q3.

In *L. Chandra Kumar vs Union of India* (1997), the Supreme Court held that judicial review under Articles 226/227 and Article 32 is part of which feature of the Constitution?

- (A) The Seventh Schedule
- (B) The Basic Structure
- (C) The Directive Principles
- (D) The Preamble

Q4.

Assertion (A): Article 323A allows State Legislatures to establish Administrative Tribunals.

Reason (R): Article 323B allows Parliament or State Legislatures to establish tribunals for specified matters.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Income Tax Appellate Tribunal	A. Parliament or State Legislatures may set up tribunals for specified matters
II. First Administrative Reforms Commission	B. Judicial review is part of the Basic Structure
III. L. Chandra Kumar case	C. First tribunal in India, established in 1941
IV. Article 323B	D. Recommended Civil Services Tribunals

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-C, II-A, III-D, IV-B
- (B) I-C, II-D, III-B, IV-A
- (C) I-C, II-A, III-B, IV-D
- (D) I-A, II-C, III-B, IV-D

Q6.

Consider the following statements about the constitutional framework for tribunals:

- I. The Income Tax Appellate Tribunal was the first tribunal in India.
- II. Article 323A allows State Legislatures to establish Administrative Tribunals.
- III. Tribunal decisions are not subject to any scrutiny by the concerned High Court.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) II and III only
- (B) I and II only
- (C) I only
- (D) I, II and III

Q7.

Consider the following statements about the Constitution's tribunal provisions:

- 1. Part XIV-A contains Articles 323A and 323B.
- 2. The First Administrative Reforms Commission recommended Civil Services Tribunals at national and state levels.
- 3. Judicial review under Articles 226/227 is not part of the Basic Structure.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Scheme Overview and Context

The Cabinet has approved a scheme named Samudra Manthan, which the booklet describes as a National Offshore Exploration Scheme. It concerns exploration beneath the sea and is focused on deep waters and frontier areas. Offshore exploration is a long process, and projects pass through several stages before any output can be expected. The booklet covers the scheme as part of its August 2026 current affairs material, under the heading of polity and governance. It sets out the

scheme's name, its approval and the broad areas in which it works. Those areas are presented as parts of one plan rather than as unrelated measures, and the booklet gives each of them a short description so that readers can follow the overall design. The scheme is also placed within the wider energy picture of the country. The booklet links offshore work to India's need for energy and to the question of how the country's oil and gas supplies can be strengthened over time. Private participation forms part of that picture, since the booklet discusses how difficult offshore projects might attract investors and how public support could change that position. Taken together, these points present the scheme as a national effort with several connected parts.

Q1.

Under which ministry is the Samudra Manthan Scheme being implemented?

- (A) Ministry of Coal
- (B) Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas
- (C) Ministry of Earth Sciences
- (D) Ministry of Mines

Q2.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Seismic Exploration	A. An integrated oil and gas manufacturing and services zone
II. Exploratory Drilling	B. Acquisition, processing and interpretation of seismic data
III. Common Infrastructure	C. Accelerated drilling in deepwater, ultra-deepwater and frontier basins
IV. Manufacturing & Services	D. Shared production and evacuation infrastructure

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-D, II-B, III-A, IV-C
- (B) I-C, II-B, III-D, IV-A
- (C) I-B, II-C, III-D, IV-A
- (D) I-C, II-D, III-A, IV-B

Q3.

Which offshore basin is named among the scheme's priority offshore regions?

- (A) Gulf of Mannar Basin
- (B) Vindhyan Basin
- (C) Cauvery Basin
- (D) Assam-Arakan Basin

Q4.

Assertion (A): The Samudra Manthan Scheme is a State Sector Scheme.

Reason (R): Offshore exploration involves high financial and technological risks.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Consider the following statements about the Samudra Manthan Scheme:

- I. The scheme aims to unlock India's offshore hydrocarbon potential.
- II. A deepwater exploratory well can cost approximately \$125-150 million.
- III. Samudrayaan is a component of the scheme.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and III only
- (B) I and II only
- (C) II and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q6.

How many of the following statements about the scheme are correct?

- I. Offshore projects have long gestation periods of around 5-10 years.
- II. The scheme is a Central Sector Scheme.
- III. Matsya6000 is a component of the scheme.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Q7.

Which key component of the scheme covers digital programme management and skill development?

- (A) Technology and Capacity Building
- (B) Seismic Exploration
- (C) Common Infrastructure
- (D) Exploratory Drilling

Significance for the Country

The booklet has a section on the significance of the scheme for India, and it links the scheme to several national concerns. The discussion places offshore work within the country's broader energy position and its industrial ambitions. It notes that a scheme of this kind can change how the country approaches its own resources, and it considers how private money might be encouraged to take part in demanding projects.

Offshore projects are described as technically difficult, and the booklet suggests that support from the government can make such projects more appealing to outside investors. That idea is central to how the scheme is presented. The section also refers to the wider effect of large activities of this kind, including the work and training that exploration programmes can bring.

The section ends by referring to the goals the country hopes to reach through its own efforts in this field, and to the role that domestic capability can play in reaching them. Taken together, these points present the scheme as more than an exploration programme, with links to energy and industry. The section keeps these links in view throughout, so the reader sees the scheme as a national project rather than a narrow exploration plan.

Q1.

Greater domestic production can reduce India's dependence on what?

- (A) Imported crude oil and gas
- (B) Imported fertilizers
- (C) Imported solar panels
- (D) Imported edible oils

Q2.

Developing indigenous offshore technologies, equipment and services is expected to reduce dependence on what?

- (A) Local labour
- (B) Coastal shipping
- (C) Foreign capabilities
- (D) Domestic banking

Q3.

What kind of employment can large-scale exploration and associated infrastructure generate?

- (A) Only seasonal fishing employment
- (B) Skilled and supporting employment
- (C) Employment limited to foreign experts
- (D) No employment effects are expected

Q4.

Consider the following statements about the significance of the scheme for India:

- I. The scheme increases dependence on imported crude oil and gas.
- II. Large-scale exploration can generate employment only for foreign experts.
- III. The scheme is said to support the Atmanirbhar Bharat goal.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q5.

How many of the following statements about the scheme are correct?

- I. Greater domestic production can reduce dependence on imported crude oil and gas.
- II. The scheme is a State Sector Scheme.
- III. Employment from the scheme is limited to fishing communities.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Q6.

Which of the following is NOT listed as a significance of the scheme for India?

- (A) Energy security
- (B) Atmanirbhar Bharat
- (C) Employment generation
- (D) Elimination of the private sector's role in exploration

Deep Ocean Mission and Submersible

India's Deep Ocean Mission is a national programme focused on the deep sea. One of its named missions is Samudrayaan, which aims to explore the bed of the ocean and is described as India's flagship deep ocean effort. The mission is built around a crewed vehicle that takes people into the deep sea, so that the exploration is carried out by people working inside a submersible.

The submersible described in the booklet is a human vehicle designed for deep-sea exploration. It is described as a state-of-the-art deep-ocean submersible, and its design is meant to withstand the pressure found at great depth. The vehicle carries a set of scientific tools for observation, sample collection and experiments, which allow the crew to study what they find.

The booklet presents the mission and the submersible together, which makes the connection between them clear. It gives a short account of the programme's background, its purpose and the equipment that supports the exploration. The section moves in a clear order, from the programme to the mission and then to the submersible, so that the reader can follow each step. The booklet describes these features in a short list, which covers the vehicle's purpose and its main equipment.

Q1.

Which ministry spearheads the Deep Ocean Mission?

- (A) Ministry of Coal
- (B) Ministry of Mines
- (C) Ministry of Earth Sciences
- (D) Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas

Q2.

Of what material is the Matsya6000 submersible constructed?

- (A) Mild steel
- (B) Titanium alloy
- (C) Aluminium alloy
- (D) Fibre-reinforced polymer

Q3.

How many aquanauts can Matsya6000 accommodate?

- (A) Two
- (B) Five
- (C) Three
- (D) Six

Q4.

Assertion (A): Matsya6000 can travel at about 5.5 km/hr.

Reason (R): It uses underwater thrusters for movement.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Consider the following statements about the Deep Ocean Mission and Matsya6000:

- I. Samudrayaan was launched in 2021.
- II. The Deep Ocean Mission was approved with a budget of Rs 4,077 crore over ten years.
- III. Matsya6000 is constructed from aluminium.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and II only
- (D) I, II and III

Q6.

How many of the following statements about the Deep Ocean Mission and Matsya6000 are correct?

- I. The crewed expedition aims to reach 6,000 metres in the central Indian Ocean.
- II. Operating endurance is 12 hours, expandable to 96 hours in emergencies.
- III. Matsya6000 accommodates five aquanauts.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Q7.

Which submersible is used for the Samudrayaan expedition?

- (A) Matsya3000
- (B) Samudra Pravah
- (C) Rohini Deep
- (D) Matsya6000

Sarnath and the World Heritage List

The Ancient Buddhist Site of Sarnath has been inscribed on the UNESCO World Heritage List. A World Heritage Site is a place that UNESCO has listed for its cultural or physical significance. The list is maintained by the World Heritage Programme and administered by the UNESCO World Heritage Committee, which meets in annual sessions.

Sarnath is where Gautama Buddha delivered his first sermon after attaining enlightenment at Bodhgaya. The event marks the beginning of the Buddhist Sangha and is associated with the establishment of the Noble Eightfold Path. Sarnath is also one of four principal Buddhist pilgrimage sites, along with Lumbini, Bodhgaya and Kushinagar.

The site contains several archaeological features. The Chaukhandi Stupa is associated with the meeting of Buddha and his first five disciples, while the Dharmarajika Stupa is traditionally linked with Emperor Ashoka and Buddha's relics. The Mulagandhakuti Vihara is associated with Buddha's rainy-season retreat.

The list classifies sites as cultural, natural or mixed, and India has a mixed heritage site. India has also hosted an annual session of the World Heritage Committee. Each proposal is assessed by expert bodies before the Committee decides. With Sarnath's inscription, the list now includes one more Indian place. The Committee is the body that makes the final decision on each site.

Q1.

How many of the following statements are correct?

- I. India served as a Committee Member for the 2021-2025 term.
 - II. Dholavira is the only Indus Valley Civilization site from India on the list.
 - III. Khangchendzonga National Park is a natural heritage site.
- (A) Only one
 - (B) Only two
 - (C) Only three
 - (D) All of the above

Q2.

Which of the following is India's mixed heritage site on the World Heritage List?

- (A) Kaziranga National Park
- (B) Khangchendzonga National Park
- (C) Sundarbans National Park
- (D) Western Ghats

Q3.

Which Indian monuments and caves were inscribed on the World Heritage List in 1983?

- (A) Red Fort, Qutub Minar and Humayun's Tomb
- (B) Sun Temple, Khajuraho and Hampi
- (C) Taj Mahal, Agra Fort, Ajanta and Ellora Caves
- (D) Fatehpur Sikri, Sanchi and Mahabalipuram

Q4.

Consider the following statements:

- I. Khangchendzonga National Park is located in Sikkim.
- II. Dholavira is located in Gujarat.
- III. The Red Fort is among the sites inscribed in 1983.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q5.

Assertion (A): Dholavira is the only Indus Valley Civilization site from India on the World Heritage List.

Reason (R): Dholavira is located in Sikkim.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q6.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Khangchendzonga National Park	A. Venue of the 46th Annual Session
II. Bharat Mandapam, New Delhi	B. Inscribed in 1983
III. Dholavira (Gujarat)	C. Mixed heritage site
IV. Taj Mahal, Agra Fort, Ajanta and Ellora Caves	D. Only Indus Valley Civilization site from India

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-B, II-C, III-A, IV-D
- (B) I-A, II-B, III-D, IV-C
- (C) I-C, II-B, III-D, IV-A
- (D) I-C, II-A, III-D, IV-B

Q7.

Where did India host the 46th Annual Session of the World Heritage Committee?

- (A) Bharat Mandapam, New Delhi
- (B) India Gate, New Delhi
- (C) Vigyan Bhawan, New Delhi
- (D) Rashtrapati Bhavan, New Delhi

UNESCO and the World Heritage Convention

UNESCO is an organisation that works in education, science and culture. Among its programmes is the World Heritage Programme, which maintains the World Heritage List. A place on that list is one that UNESCO has recognised for its cultural or physical significance. Sites recognised under the list are described as World Heritage Sites.

The rules for this recognition are set out in an international treaty called the Convention concerning Protection of World Cultural and Natural Heritage. Countries join the treaty through ratification, and India is one of the countries that has done so. The World Heritage Committee administers the list, while the treaty embodies the recognition process itself.

Sites on the list fall into several categories, including cultural, natural and mixed sites. Before a

site is added, it is reviewed by expert organisations, and the process ends with a final stage. The list sits alongside other UNESCO efforts, such as the Memory of the World Register, the Man and Biosphere Programme and Intangible Cultural Heritage.

The Convention names both cultural and natural heritage in its title, which is why the list covers both kinds of places. UNESCO's full name, United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization, reflects its work in these three fields.

Q1.

In which year did the World Heritage Convention formally take effect?

- (A) 1972
- (B) 1975
- (C) 1977
- (D) 1983

Q2.

Which agency is the nodal agency in India for UNESCO World Heritage matters?

- (A) Indian Council of Historical Research
- (B) National Monuments Authority
- (C) Ministry of Culture
- (D) Archaeological Survey of India

Q3.

Which two bodies assess sites before the World Heritage Committee makes its final decision?

- (A) UNESCO Secretariat and UNDP
- (B) WHO and UNEP
- (C) ICOMOS and IUCN
- (D) UNGA and UNSC

Q4.

Assertion (A): The World Heritage Committee carries out the assessment of sites before the final decision.

Reason (R): ICOMOS and IUCN carry out the assessment of sites for the Committee.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Convention adopted by UNESCO	A. 1977
II. Convention formally took effect	B. Paris
III. UNESCO headquarters	C. 1975
IV. India ratified the Convention	D. 1972

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-D, II-C, III-B, IV-A
- (B) I-B, II-D, III-A, IV-C
- (C) I-C, II-A, III-D, IV-B
- (D) I-D, II-A, III-B, IV-C

Q6.

Consider the following statements:

- I. UNESCO was founded in 1945.
- II. The Convention concerning Protection of World Cultural and Natural Heritage was adopted in 1972.
- III. The World Heritage List is administered by the Archaeological Survey of India.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I, II and III
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and II only
- (D) I and III only

Q7.

How many of the following statements are correct?

- I. Final decisions on World Heritage Sites are made by the World Heritage Committee.
- II. The Convention formally took effect in 1977.
- III. The Archaeological Survey of India is the nodal agency for World Heritage matters in India.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

COP17 Finance and Partnerships

The United Nations Convention to Combat Desertification is one of three Rio Conventions, along with the UNFCCC and the CBD. It was adopted on 17 June 1994, a date now observed as World Day to Combat Desertification. It is the principal international legally binding framework dealing with desertification, land degradation and drought, and its core objective is to promote sustainable land management. The convention aims to achieve land degradation neutrality by 2030, a goal linked with SDG Target 15.3.

The seventeenth Conference of the Parties concluded in Ulaanbaatar, Mongolia, under the theme 'Restoring Land. Restoring Hope.' The meeting coincided with the UN International Year of Rangelands and Pastoralists 2026, which placed greater emphasis on pastoral communities and sustainable rangeland management.

Land degradation has emerged as a major threat to ecosystems, agriculture and economic stability. The convention has built platforms that bring together public money and private investors. One of these is a drought partnership that was launched at an earlier COP and aims to help countries that are vulnerable to drought. Another is a major platform through which the convention involves the private sector in land-related work.

COP17 also promoted several approaches that rely on healthy ecosystems. Mongolia highlighted the severity of its own land degradation challenge during the meeting.

Q1.

According to the booklet, COP17 promoted ecosystem restoration within which kind of planning?

- (A) National development planning
- (B) Coastal zone planning
- (C) Urban transport planning
- (D) Nuclear energy planning

Q2.

How many of the following statements are true?

Business4Land Initiative covers water management as well as land restoration.

The Riyadh partnership aims to support 100 vulnerable countries.

COP17 promoted greater adoption of Nature-based Solutions.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Q3.

What approach does the booklet say the land degradation crisis highlights the need for?

- (A) Isolated restoration of single plots
- (B) Expansion of urban farmland
- (C) Removal of all grasslands
- (D) Landscape-level restoration rather than isolated interventions

Q4.

Which platform is described in the booklet as UNCCD's major means of involving the private sector in sustainable land management, water management and land restoration?

- (A) Mission Amrit Sarovar
- (B) Green India Mission
- (C) Business4Land Initiative
- (D) Aravalli Green Wall Initiative

Q5.

Read the assertion and reason below and choose the correct option.

Assertion (A): The Riyadh Global Drought Resilience Partnership initially secured around USD 2.15 billion in commitments.

Reason (R): The partnership aims to support 80 vulnerable and drought-affected countries through public and private finance.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q6.

Consider the following statements:

I. The Riyadh Global Drought Resilience Partnership was launched during UNCCD COP 16 in Riyadh in 2024.

II. Business4Land Initiative covers sustainable land management, water management and land restoration.

III. The Riyadh Global Drought Resilience Partnership was launched during COP17 in Ulaanbaatar.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and III only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and II only
- (D) I, II and III

Q7.

According to the booklet, what is the stated objective of using healthy ecosystems?

- (A) Strengthening climate and drought resilience
- (B) Replacing all farmland with forests
- (C) Eliminating desertification entirely by 2050
- (D) Increasing urban water supply

India's Land Restoration Programmes

The United Nations Convention to Combat Desertification is one of three Rio Conventions, along with the UNFCCC and the CBD. It is the principal international legally binding framework dealing with desertification, land degradation and drought. Its core objective is to promote sustainable land management, and it is linked with SDG Target 15.3.

Land degradation neutrality describes a condition in which the quantity and quality of land resources needed to support ecosystem functions and services remain stable or improve.

The most recent conference of the Parties was held in Ulaanbaatar, Mongolia, under the theme 'Restoring Land. Restoring Hope.' It coincided with the UN International Year of Rangelands and Pastoralists 2026, which placed greater emphasis on pastoral communities and sustainable rangeland management.

Land degradation has emerged as a major threat to ecosystems, agriculture and economic stability. Mongolia highlighted the severity of its own land degradation challenge during the meeting. The booklet describes an objective of using healthy ecosystems as a means of strengthening climate and drought resilience.

India attended the meeting and presented its own work on land. India also runs several national programmes that address land degradation, which the booklet describes as part of its own land efforts. The meeting also promoted greater use of nature-based approaches, which relate to ecosystems and development planning.

Q1.

In which year was the National Action Plan to Combat Desertification introduced?

- (A) 1994
- (B) 2001
- (C) 2011
- (D) 2023

Q2.

Which of the following ecosystems is named as covered by India's Guide to Grasslands and Other Open Natural Ecosystems?

- (A) Western Ghats
- (B) Sundarbans
- (C) Himalayan glaciers
- (D) Thar Desert

Q3.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Green India Mission	A. Restoration of degraded areas associated with the Aravalli landscape
II. Mission Amrit Sarovar	B. Forest restoration and enhancement of carbon sequestration
III. Aravalli Green Wall Initiative	C. Overarching framework for coordinating interventions on land restoration and desertification control
IV. National Action Plan to Combat Desertification	D. Creation and rejuvenation of water bodies

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-B, II-D, III-A, IV-C
- (B) I-A, II-D, III-B, IV-C
- (C) I-A, II-C, III-D, IV-B
- (D) I-D, II-C, III-B, IV-A

Q4.

Consider the following statements:

- I. India is a Party to the UNCCD.
- II. India's Guide to Grasslands and Other Open Natural Ecosystems was launched at COP 16 in Riyadh.
- III. The Guide covers the Deccan Savannas and Ravines among other open ecosystems.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q5.

How many of the following statements are true?

The National Action Plan to Combat Desertification was revised in 2023.

The Aravalli Green Wall Initiative focuses on the creation of water bodies.

The Green India Mission is a component of the National Action Plan on Climate Change.

- (A) Only two
- (B) Only one
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Q6.

What did India launch at COP17 to improve recognition of ecosystems such as the Thar Desert and Banni Grasslands?

- (A) National Grassland Mission
- (B) Desert Conservation Policy
- (C) Guide to Grasslands and Other Open Natural Ecosystems
- (D) Open Ecosystems Charter

Global Initiatives: IUCN, NTCA and IBCA (MCQ)

Global Tiger Day is observed annually by IUCN, and its official theme is Coexistence in action: Scaling solutions for people and tigers. Several initiatives link to this theme. The Integrated Tiger Habitat Conservation Programme is an IUCN initiative that supports habitat restoration, anti-poaching measures and community-led coexistence. The National Tiger Conservation

Authority, which works under the environment ministry, has also launched the NTCA Eco-Tourism Initiative. The initiative is described as integrated, so related services are brought together for visitors. Conservation of big cats also extends beyond tigers. The International Big Cat Alliance is a global initiative that covers several big cat species, not only the tiger. Countries can join the International Big Cat Alliance as ratifying members. The programmes described here work at different levels, some on habitats and others through visitor services or international membership. Tigers are also the national animal of India, known as the Royal Bengal Tiger. Tiger conservation in India is supported by Project Tiger, a programme overseen by the National Tiger Conservation Authority. Tigers are the focus of the Global Tiger Day observance. Each initiative has its own scope, and each contributes to the wider goal of protecting tigers and other big cats in the wild.

Q1.

Which of the following is one of the seven big cat species covered by the International Big Cat Alliance?

- (A) Wolf
- (B) Cheetah
- (C) Hyena
- (D) Wild dog

Q2.

In which region does the IUCN Integrated Tiger Habitat Conservation Programme operate?

- (A) Africa
- (B) Asia
- (C) South America
- (D) Europe

Q3.

In which year was the International Big Cat Alliance launched?

- (A) 2010
- (B) 2014
- (C) 2023
- (D) 2026

Q4.

Assertion (A): The International Big Cat Alliance covers seven big cat species.

Reason (R): Countries can become ratifying members of the International Big Cat Alliance.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. International Big Cat Alliance	A. IUCN initiative
II. NTCA Eco-Tourism Initiative	B. Postponed
III. 1st International Big Cat Alliance Summit	C. India-led
IV. Integrated Tiger Habitat Conservation Programme	D. Integrated platform for safari and accommodation bookings

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-B, II-D, III-A, IV-C
- (B) I-A, II-B, III-C, IV-D
- (C) I-B, II-C, III-D, IV-A
- (D) I-C, II-D, III-B, IV-A

Q6.

Consider the following statements:

- I. The IUCN Integrated Tiger Habitat Conservation Programme covers habitat restoration and anti-poaching measures.
- II. The NTCA Eco-Tourism Initiative is a platform for safari and accommodation bookings.
- III. The International Big Cat Alliance covers eight big cat species.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) I and III only
- (C) II and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q7.

How many of the following statements are correct?

- I. Global Tiger Day is observed annually by IUCN.
- II. The International Big Cat Alliance was launched in 2010.
- III. The NTCA Eco-Tourism Initiative was launched by the National Tiger Conservation Authority.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Indian Institutions and Milestones (MCQ)

India's wildlife protection rests on a set of statutory bodies, policies and programmes. Its scope covers both animals and the forest areas they live in. Project Tiger is a programme set up to support the preservation of tigers in India. It works through tiger reserves, which are notified by state governments. Monitoring of these reserves is also an important part of the work, and one system used in this area carries the name M-STrIPES. Tiger population is estimated through a census cycle, repeated at fixed intervals. More than one institution takes part in the census. Project Tiger is overseen by the National Tiger Conservation Authority, which is a statutory body under the Wild Life Protection Act. Tiger reserves are specially designated protected areas under Project Tiger. Changes to the boundaries of a tiger reserve require a recommendation from the authority and approval of the National Board for Wild Life. Legal and administrative steps have shaped the system over time. The Wild Life Protection Act was amended in 2006. The authority works under the environment ministry and is chaired by the minister in charge of that ministry.

Q1.

Consider the following statements:

- I. The Wild Life Protection Act was enacted in 1972.
- II. The tiger census is conducted every three years.
- III. M-STrIPES was introduced in 2010.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and III only
- (B) I and II only
- (C) II and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q2.

How many of the following statements are correct?

- I. The export ban on wild cat skins was imposed in 1969.
 - II. The 2006 amendment to the wildlife law resulted in the creation of the Wildlife Crime Control Bureau.
 - III. The National Tiger Conservation Authority was established in 2010.
- (A) Only one
 - (B) Only two
 - (C) Only three
 - (D) All of the above

Q3.

What does M-STrIPES stand for?

- (A) Multi-State Tiger Reporting and Information Program for Ecological Safety
- (B) Management System for Tiger Rehabilitation in Protected Ecosystems
- (C) Mapping System for Tiger Range and Indigenous Protection
- (D) Monitoring System for Tigers - Intensive Protection and Ecological Status

Q4.

How many years does one tiger census cycle last?

- (A) 2 years
- (B) 3 years
- (C) 4 years
- (D) 5 years

Q5.

Which trade was banned in India in 1969?

- (A) Export of ivory
- (B) Export of all wild cat skins
- (C) Import of tiger bones
- (D) Sale of forest timber

Q6.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. 1969	A. Software-based monitoring system for tiger reserves (M-STrIPES)
II. 1972	B. International Big Cat Alliance launched
III. 2010	C. Ban on export of wild cat skins
IV. 2023	D. Wild Life Protection Act enacted

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-D, II-C, III-B, IV-A
- (B) I-A, II-C, III-B, IV-D
- (C) I-C, II-D, III-A, IV-B
- (D) I-B, II-C, III-D, IV-A

Wetlands and Their Forms: MCQ

A wetland is a place in which the land is covered by water. That water may be salt, fresh or somewhere in between. Wetlands take many forms, so the term covers a wide range of landscapes. Lakes and rivers are among the most familiar of them, and swamps and wet grasslands also count as wetlands. Along the coast, mangroves are one of the forms the booklet describes, and coral reefs and other coastal areas appear in the same list. Marshes and bogs are also listed among the forms of wetlands. Some forms sit inland, while others lie near the sea. Wet grasslands and peatlands

show that the water need not always form a lake. The booklet's list of water bodies is long, and it reaches from freshwater lakes to sea-edge habitats. The common feature in the definition is that land is covered by water, rather than any single shape or size. This is why a wetland can be a large lake, a river, a swamp or a stretch of grassland. The definition therefore allows a broad range of habitats to be counted within one category. Each of these forms is still a place where the land is covered by water. The booklet presents these forms as examples of a single category, which is the wetland.

Q1.

How many segments are wetlands classified into?

- (A) Two
- (B) Three
- (C) Four
- (D) Five

Q2.

Which of these is one of the segments into which wetlands are classified?

- (A) Seasonal wetlands
- (B) Tidal wetlands
- (C) Urban wetlands
- (D) Human-made wetlands

Q3.

Which of these is named among the other forms of wetlands in the booklet?

- (A) Floodplains
- (B) Glaciers
- (C) Plateaus
- (D) Dunes

Q4.

Which of these is listed alongside peatlands and wet grasslands in the booklet's list of water bodies?

- (A) Savannas
- (B) Dunes
- (C) Deltas
- (D) Glaciers

Q5.

Assertion (A): Wetlands can be covered by water for part of the year.

Reason (R): The water cover of a wetland may be seasonal.

- (A) A is true but R is false
- (B) Both A and R are true and R explains A
- (C) Both A and R are true but R does not explain A
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q6.

- I. Tidal flats are named among the forms of wetland in the booklet.
- II. Human-made wetlands is one of the three segments of wetlands.
- III. Ponds are classified as a segment of wetlands.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) II and III only
- (B) I and III only
- (C) I and II only
- (D) I, II and III

Q7.

- I. Mudflats are named among the forms of wetlands.
- II. Ponds are named among the forms of wetlands.
- III. Wetlands are classified into four segments.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Ramsar Convention in Brief: MCQ

The Ramsar Convention is an intergovernmental treaty that concerns wetlands. It is a formal agreement among its member countries, and it has 172 member states. The treaty focuses on wetlands of international importance. India is one of the countries that take part in the treaty. World Wetlands Day is observed every year to draw attention to wetlands and their value. Each year's observance carries a theme. The treaty takes its name from the Iranian city of Ramsar, where it was signed. The Montreux Record is a register of wetland sites. It records sites where changes in ecological character have occurred or are likely to occur. Such changes may result from technological developments, pollution or other human interference. Indian wetlands have appeared in the record. The Montreux Record is one of the tools linked to the treaty's work. Wetlands are areas of land covered by water, which may be salt, fresh or in between. The booklet describes wetlands as places with many water bodies, such as lakes, rivers and swamps. Wetlands are associated in the booklet with biodiversity and carbon stock. Wetland conservation is therefore a shared concern for the countries in the treaty.

Q1.

What is the theme of World Wetlands Day 2026?

- (A) Wetlands and Water
- (B) Wetlands for a Sustainable Future
- (C) Restore Wetlands Now
- (D) Wetlands and Traditional Knowledge: Celebrating Cultural Heritage

Q2.

How often does the Conference of Parties (COP) to the Ramsar Convention meet?

- (A) Every year
- (B) Every 3 years
- (C) Every 2 years
- (D) Every 5 years

Q3.

What is the official name of the Ramsar Convention?

- (A) Convention on Wetlands of International Importance
- (B) Convention on Biological Diversity
- (C) Convention on Migratory Species
- (D) Convention on International Trade in Endangered Species

Q4.

Assertion (A): Wetlands of international importance are declared as Ramsar sites.

Reason (R): The Ramsar Convention is the only international treaty that addresses a specific ecosystem.

- (A) A is true but R is false
- (B) Both A and R are true and R explains A
- (C) Both A and R are true but R does not explain A
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Montreux Record was launched in	A. 1982
II. Ramsar Convention came into force in	B. 2 February
III. India became a signatory in	C. 1975
IV. World Wetlands Day is observed on	D. 1990

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-B, II-A, III-C, IV-D
- (B) I-D, II-C, III-A, IV-B
- (C) I-A, II-B, III-D, IV-C
- (D) I-A, II-D, III-C, IV-B

Q6.

- I. COP14 of the Ramsar Convention was co-held in 2022 in Wuhan (China) and Geneva (Switzerland).
- II. The Montreux Record identifies Ramsar sites that need priority conservation attention.
- III. World Wetlands Day is celebrated on 22 March.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) II and III only
- (B) I and III only
- (C) I and II only
- (D) I, II and III

Q7.

- I. The Convention was adopted in 1971 in Ramsar, Iran.
- II. The Conference of Parties meets every 2 years.
- III. The Ramsar Convention has been in force since 1971.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Notable Indian achievements at Glasgow 2026

The 23rd Commonwealth Games were held in Glasgow, Scotland, from 23 July to 2 August 2026, and brought athletes from many nations into one multi-sport programme. The Commonwealth Games are generally held once every four years, and the event is organised by the Commonwealth Games Federation. The idea of a Commonwealth-wide sporting competition can be traced to 1911. The booklet highlights individual athletes who produced notable performances, and it records several historic results for Indian competitors at this edition. Boxing was one of the sports in which Indian athletes performed strongly, and women boxers from India won gold medals in their events. The booklet also describes a weightlifter's results across several Games. In athletics, a javelin thrower from India took part in the men's event, returning to the Games after a gap in his participation. India's contingent also included para-athletes. The booklet presents these results in a section on India's historic achievements. The Games are contested across a range of sports, and the booklet gives its account of Indian achievements alongside the overall medal figures for the event. This edition was the one held in Glasgow in 2026, and its results are the subject of the booklet's section on Indian achievements.

Q1.

Which Indian boxer won the Women's 57 kg boxing gold at Glasgow 2026?

- (A) Preeti Pawar
- (B) Jaismine Lamboria
- (C) Priya Ghanghas
- (D) Arundhati Choudhary

Q2.

Which two Indian athletes became India's first-ever Commonwealth Games gold medallists in judo?

- (A) Asmita Dey and Harsh Singh
- (B) Sushil Kumar and Bajrang Punia
- (C) Tulika Maan and Linthoi Chanambam
- (D) Vijay Kumar and Deepak Punia

Q3.

Which edition of the Commonwealth Games did Neeraj Chopra miss before returning at Glasgow 2026?

- (A) Gold Coast 2018
- (B) Delhi 2010
- (C) Birmingham 2022
- (D) Glasgow 2014

Q4.

Examine the assertion and reason given below.

Assertion (A): Neeraj Chopra won the gold medal in the men's javelin throw at Glasgow 2026.

Reason (R): Neeraj Chopra received the Commonwealth Flag at the Glasgow 2026 Games.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Mirabai Chanu	A. Javelin throw
II. Asmita Dey and Harsh Singh	B. Boxing (57 kg)
III. Jaismine Lamboria	C. Judo
IV. Neeraj Chopra	D. Weightlifting

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-C, II-A, III-B, IV-D
- (B) I-D, II-C, III-B, IV-A
- (C) I-A, II-C, III-B, IV-D
- (D) I-B, II-C, III-D, IV-A

Q6.

Read the statements below about India at Glasgow 2026:

- I. Five women boxers from India won gold at Glasgow 2026.
- II. Mirabai Chanu won Commonwealth Games gold medals at Gold Coast 2018, Birmingham 2022 and Glasgow 2026.
- III. Mirabai Chanu won her first Commonwealth Games gold medal at Glasgow 2026.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and III only
- (B) I, II and III
- (C) I and II only
- (D) II and III only

Q7.

How many of the statements below are correct?

- I. Jaismine Lamboria won the Women's 57 kg boxing gold.
- II. Asmita Dey and Harsh Singh were India's first-ever Commonwealth Games gold medallists in judo.
- III. Mirabai Chanu won three consecutive Commonwealth Games gold medals in boxing.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Defence Pact, Summit and River Treaty

Several developments in international affairs drew attention recently. Three countries in West Asia signed a defence arrangement that aims to strengthen military cooperation among them and to contribute to peace and stability in the region. The arrangement provides a framework for enhanced defence coordination, security cooperation and military interaction. The arrangement reflects a move toward regional ownership of security, in which West Asian nations take primary responsibility for their own defence. A summit of the North Atlantic Treaty Organisation, held in Türkiye, reviewed defence spending and support for Ukraine. Leaders reaffirmed their commitment to collective defence and to the Washington Treaty. Members also committed to expanding Europe's defence industrial capacity through research centres and skilled workforce development. A river-sharing treaty between India and Bangladesh governs how Ganga waters are shared during the dry season. The treaty is a long-standing arrangement that establishes a formula for distributing water in the lean season. The treaty sets out a mechanism for cooperation between two neighbouring countries over a shared river system. In the Pacific, a small island nation chose to adopt a new formal name to strengthen its cultural identity and national sovereignty. Another item concerns the Ganga treaty's dry-season coverage, which runs from January to 31 May.

Q1.

The Mecca Joint Defence Agreement treats an armed attack against one member as what?

- (A) A matter for bilateral talks only
- (B) A concern limited to the attacked member
- (C) An attack on all three members
- (D) A matter for the United Nations Security Council

Q2.

The 1996 Ganga Water Sharing Treaty is scheduled to expire in which month and year?

- (A) May 2026
- (B) December 2025
- (C) January 2027
- (D) December 2026

Q3.

Which body classified the indigenous Naoero language as severely endangered?

- (A) Pacific Islands Forum
- (B) Commonwealth Secretariat
- (C) UNESCO
- (D) World Health Organization

Q4.

Assertion (A): The Mecca Joint Defence Agreement is meant to replace existing regional and international security mechanisms.

Reason (R): The agreement is intended to complement existing regional and international security mechanisms rather than replace them.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Farakka Barrage	A. Republic of Naoero
II. Hague Defence Commitment	B. Pakistan, Saudi Arabia and Türkiye
III. Nauru's new indigenous name	C. Murshidabad, West Bengal
IV. Mecca Joint Defence Agreement	D. 5% of GDP on defence by 2035

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-D, II-C, III-B, IV-A
- (B) I-C, II-D, III-A, IV-B
- (C) I-D, II-B, III-A, IV-C
- (D) I-B, II-A, III-D, IV-C

Q6.

Consider the following statements:

- I. The Mecca Joint Defence Agreement seeks to strengthen the ability of three countries to deter external aggression.
- II. The 1996 Ganga Water Sharing Treaty provides a guaranteed minimum flow, unlike the 1977 arrangement.
- III. If available Ganga flow falls below 50000 cusecs, India and Bangladesh must hold emergency consultations.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and III only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and II only
- (D) I, II and III

Q7.

Consider the following statements:

The NATO Ankara Summit 2026 followed the 2025 Hague Summit.

NATO members endorsed a commitment to spend 5% of GDP on defence by 2030.

The Mecca Joint Defence Agreement is an alliance aimed at a particular country.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Statistics Bill and Digital Safety

Several governance and welfare measures were in the news this month. A Bill introduced in the Lok Sabha seeks to reform the Indian Statistical Institute, which was founded in 1931 and has its headquarters in Kolkata. The Bill would convert the institute into a statutory body corporate and replace its existing council with a smaller board. Parliament also passed an amendment that widens the financing role of a national body that supports cooperative societies. The body was established in 1963 and its core mandate is to promote and finance cooperative development. The cooperative sector is also addressed by the Constitution, which directs the state to promote voluntary formation of cooperatives. A central employment scheme completed its first year, and it is designed to promote first-time jobs and to support social security coverage. Meanwhile, a social media company announced new default protections for teenage users after a settlement with many state attorneys general in the United States. The protections cover daily use, engagement metrics and the way content is ranked for teen accounts. The founder, Prasanta Chandra Mahalanobis, is regarded as the father of Indian statistics. National Statistics Day, observed on 29 June, honours his contributions to the field. The Bill's changes to governance affect how the institute is run and who oversees its functioning.

Q1.

Under the Indian Statistical Institute Bill 2026, who would become the Visitor of the Institute?

- (A) The Prime Minister of India
- (B) The Chairperson of the Board of Governors
- (C) The President of India
- (D) The Union Minister for Statistics

Q2.

Under the Bill, who appoints the Director of the Indian Statistical Institute?

- (A) The Visitor alone
- (B) The Board, with the Visitor's prior approval
- (C) The 33-member Council
- (D) The Union Cabinet

Q3.

Under the Meta teen safety measures, what is the cumulative daily limit across Instagram and Facebook?

- (A) 1 hour
- (B) 3 hours
- (C) 4 hours
- (D) 2 hours

Q4.

Assertion (A): The Indian Statistical Institute Bill 2026 would require central approval for every set of regulations made by the Institute.

Reason (R): Under the Bill, central approval would be required only for the first set of regulations.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Indian Statistical Institute Bill 2026	A. Implemented through the Employees' Provident Fund Organisation
II. National Cooperative Development Corporation (Amendment) Bill, 2026	B. Restricts Feed, Stories and Reels from 12 midnight to 6 AM
III. Pradhan Mantri Viksit Bharat Rojgar Yojana (PM-VBRY)	C. Allows direct loans and grants to any cooperative society
IV. Meta's night-time restriction	D. Seeks to repeal the Indian Statistical Institute Act, 1959

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-A, II-B, III-C, IV-D
- (B) I-D, II-C, III-A, IV-B
- (C) I-B, II-D, III-A, IV-C
- (D) I-D, II-A, III-B, IV-C

Q6.

Consider the following statements:

I. The Visitor under the Bill can order inquiries and issue binding directions.

II. The National Cooperative Development Corporation can now lend or grant funds directly to any cooperative society, subject to prescribed conditions.

III. PM-VBRY's first-time employee incentive is paid in three instalments.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and III only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and II only
- (D) I, II and III

Q7.

Consider the following statements:

The PM-VBRY implementation period runs from 1 August 2025 to 31 July 2027.

Under the Meta measures, messaging is counted within the daily time limit.

Under the Bill, the Director would be appointed directly by the Visitor.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Prizes, Medals and Maize

Awards and scientific recognition have featured in recent news. A major prize in mathematics was given to a group of mathematicians for exceptional contributions to research, and one of the

recipients is a woman. The prize recognises existing achievement in the field as well as the promise of future contributions. The Fields Medal was financed by a trust established at a university in Canada. Earlier winners included mathematicians of Indian origin. Separately, an Indian astrophysics director received a medal from a body that promotes international cooperation in space research. The medal is named after a founder of India's space programme. The Indian Institute of Astrophysics is based in Bengaluru. The COSPAR body was established in 1958 and is affiliated with the International Science Council. The COSPAR award is a medal conferred at an international assembly of scientists. In agriculture, a new seed product was launched in a southern Indian state. The seed was launched at a processing facility run by a popcorn business. The seed is indigenous, and it does not involve genetically modified material. Maize is a major crop in India, and production was reported in millions of tonnes for 2025-26. Each of these items relates to a different field, from mathematics to space research to agriculture.

Q1.

Which body awards the Fields Medal?

- (A) Royal Society of London
- (B) International Mathematical Union
- (C) University of Toronto
- (D) Committee on Space Research

Q2.

Which Indian scientist received the 2026 COSPAR Vikram Sarabhai Medal?

- (A) Gurbax Singh Lakhina
- (B) Anil Bharadwaj
- (C) Annapurni Subramaniam
- (D) UR Rao

Q3.

The COSPAR Vikram Sarabhai Medal honours scientists from which group of countries?

- (A) Developed countries
- (B) Developing countries
- (C) Member states of the European Union
- (D) Commonwealth countries

Q4.

Assertion (A): The COSPAR Vikram Sarabhai Medal is awarded biennially.

Reason (R): The medal was established in 1990 in honour of Vikram Sarabhai.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Fields Medal	A. Third woman to win the Fields Medal
II. COSPAR Vikram Sarabhai Medal	B. Awarded once every four years
III. Popcorn maize hybrid seed	C. Conferred at the 46th Scientific Assembly in Florence, Italy
IV. Hong Wang	D. Launched at Musunuru, Eluru, Andhra Pradesh

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-B, II-D, III-C, IV-A
- (B) I-C, II-B, III-A, IV-D
- (C) I-C, II-B, III-D, IV-A
- (D) I-B, II-C, III-D, IV-A

Q6.

Consider the following statements:

- I. Two to four mathematicians may be honoured in each Fields Medal cycle.
- II. Fields Medal recipients must be 40 years or older at the time of the award.
- III. The Fields Medal was established in 1936 through the efforts of John Charles Fields.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and III only
- (B) I and II only
- (C) II and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q7.

Consider the following statements:

India's indigenous, non-GMO popcorn maize hybrid was launched at Musunuru in Andhra Pradesh.

Hong Wang was the first woman to win the Fields Medal.

The popcorn maize hybrid was developed by ICAR-Indian Institute of Maize Research in collaboration with Gourmet Popcornica.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only two
- (B) Only one
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Type-in-the-answer passages

Refugee and trafficking treaties

International law on refugees and trafficking is built from several separate agreements rather than one document. Some agreements focus on organised crime and on protecting people, especially women and children, from being exploited. Others define who counts as a refugee, what rights that person should have, and why a refugee must not be sent back to a place of danger. Still other treaties cover civil and political rights, and they include protections against cruel treatment when a person is returned to their home country. The framework also reaches children, whose welfare in conflict and displacement is addressed by a separate treaty on their rights. The Global Compact on Refugees (2018) offers a framework to support refugees and host countries. The Global Refugee Forum is held every four years to address challenges faced by refugees and host communities. India is not a signatory to the 1951 Refugee Convention and 1967 Protocol. Each agreement was written for a different purpose, so their scope and obligations vary. Overall, the system combines

criminal law, human rights and humanitarian commitments into one broad structure.

Q1.

In which year was the Palermo Protocol adopted? (year)

Answer: _____

Q2.

In which year was the United Nations Relief and Works Agency established? (year)

Answer: _____

Q3.

In which year was the Convention on the Rights of the Child adopted? (year)

Answer: _____

Q4.

In which year was the Global Compact on Refugees framework introduced? (year)

Answer: _____

Q5.

How often is the Global Refugee Forum held? (in years)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Which country, named in the booklet, is not a signatory to the 1951 Refugee Convention or the 1967 Protocol?

Answer: _____

Antelope Reef Facts

Antelope Reef has moved to the centre of debate over military activity in the South China Sea. The reef lies in a group of islands where several states have competing claims, and the area is among the busiest maritime zones in the world. Shipping that carries a large share of global trade moves through these waters every year, so any change in the region draws close attention from neighbouring countries and from trading nations far away.

Reports describe construction work that has transformed the reef, with reclaimed land, a wharf and other port facilities built alongside. Such facilities are often linked to naval use, but the government that controls the site has described its work differently and has pointed to scientific research. The reef could support larger operations over time.

Security experts have discussed what such a base could mean for the wider balance of power. A secure base for large submarines would be valuable to any navy, and a well-equipped reef could also support surveillance and patrols. Neighbouring countries have reason for concern, since military facilities on disputed features could change how the sea is used and who controls its routes.

Questions for the region now include how these developments fit into a broader plan to strengthen maritime influence, and whether other states will respond with their own installations.

Q1.

In which disputed island group is Antelope Reef located? (name the group)

Answer: _____

Q2.

What is the approximate length of the wharf built at Antelope Reef? (in metres)

Answer: _____

Q3.

What is the approximate size of the artificial island China has reclaimed at Antelope Reef? (in km)

Answer: _____

Q4.

China says the Antelope Reef development serves which kind of purposes? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q5.

What strategic term describes a protected maritime zone for China's nuclear-powered submarines that Antelope Reef could create? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Roughly how long is the straight coastline at Antelope Reef that is potentially suitable for an airstrip or runway? (in km)

Answer: _____

Term, appointment and rotation

The selection of the UN Secretary-General combines written rules with long-standing custom. The founding Charter explains how the post is filled, but it does not set a limit on how long the holder may serve. Over time, a standard length of office has developed through practice, and the holder is normally allowed to seek a further term, although this rests on custom rather than written rules. The Security Council plays the decisive role in the process. The Council has fifteen members, and each one holds a single vote, so its recommendation reflects collective judgment rather than the preference of one state. When the Council settles on a candidate, its recommendation passes to the wider membership of the United Nations, which makes the formal appointment. Even though that wider body could decide by a simple majority, appointments have usually been made without a vote, through agreement or general approval. The choice is also shaped by an unwritten expectation that the post should move between different parts of the world. This expectation is meant to give every region a fair chance of representation at the top of the organisation. Candidates are expected to present their experience and their vision for the organisation before member states. The practice reflects an effort to balance representation across the world.

Q1.

What is the conventional length, in years, of a Secretary-General's term under established UN practice? (in years)

Answer: _____

Q2.

How many times is a Secretary-General's term conventionally renewable? (answer in digits)

Answer: _____

Q3.

Under which Article of the UN Charter is the Secretary-General appointed on the Council's recommendation? (answer as the article number)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Which informal principle, aimed at geographical representation, has traditionally guided the choice of Secretary-General?

Answer: _____

Q5.

How many broad regional groupings are involved in the regional rotation principle? (in number)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Is regional rotation a legally binding provision of the UN Charter? (answer yes or no)

Answer: _____

Q7.

Which UN body formally appoints the Secretary-General? (name the body)

Answer: _____

CWMA quick recall

Implementing a river water award requires a permanent institution, and for the Cauvery the government set up a dedicated authority. The body was created together with a regulation committee, so that management and monitoring work could be divided. Its legal character is that of a statutory and quasi-judicial body, which means it has a legal basis in a central law on inter-state river disputes. Its main job is to give effect to the modified tribunal award, which the country's highest court had upheld. The authority is headed by a senior official who serves for a fixed term, and it includes full-time and part-time members. Members come from the basin states and a union territory as well as from the central government, so that all stakeholders have a voice in decisions. The authority's functions include ensuring that water is released as directed, which makes its work closely watched by the states. Its work has come into sharp focus recently, after it endorsed an order on water releases from one state to another. Understanding its composition and legal status helps explain how the Cauvery dispute is managed today. Because its decisions affect farmers and cities alike, the authority plays a central role in the dispute.

Q1.

In which year was the Cauvery Water Management Authority established?

Answer: _____

Q2.

For how many years does the Chairperson of the Authority serve? (in years)

Answer: _____

Q3.

Under which Section of the Inter-State River Water Disputes Act, 1956 is the Authority notified?

Answer: _____

Q4.

In which city is the Authority's headquarters located?

Answer: _____

Q5.

How many full-time members does the Authority have? (in number)

Answer: _____

Q6.

How many part-time members represent the basin states and UT on the Authority? (in number)

Answer: _____

Q7.

Under which Union Ministry does the Authority's headquarters function?

Answer: _____

Institutions and Challenges Recall

Successive arrangements have tried to give the Darjeeling hill region a measure of self-governance since the agitation of the 1980s. The first such body was a hill council set up after that agitation to provide greater autonomy to the region. Its effectiveness, however, was constrained by limited legislative authority, inadequate financial autonomy and dependence on the state government. A later, more empowered autonomous arrangement was created, with greater administrative, executive and financial responsibilities than the council. Demands for a fuller political solution have nevertheless continued. Opposition in parts of the state to any further territorial division is based on concerns about territorial integrity, economic interests and administrative cohesion. The Darjeeling region also occupies a sensitive geographical position, close to three neighbouring countries. Its corridor is the main land link between mainland India and the Northeast, so prolonged instability there could have wider security implications. Gorkha politics is itself divided among several organisations and groups, which makes a common position difficult. The regional economy depends on tea, tourism and related activities, which face structural and seasonal challenges.

Q1.

In which year was the Darjeeling Gorkha Hill Council established? (give the year)

Answer: _____

Q2.

In which year was the Gorkhaland Territorial Administration established? (give the year)

Answer: _____

Q3.

Who heads the committee constituted by the Union Government to work out a 'Permanent Political Solution'? (full name)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Which corridor, also called Chicken's Neck, is located in the Darjeeling region? (two words)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Besides the Gorkha National Liberation Front, which other Gorkha political group is named as part of the fragmented political representation? (full name)

Answer: _____

Q6.

How many Gorkha communities are proposed for a roadmap to Scheduled Tribe status? (give the number)

Answer: _____

Speedy trial TITA

Long pendency of criminal cases is a concern that the amendment addresses for examination offences. Fast-Track Courts are meant to speed up trials of cases that have remained pending for

long periods. The amended law now gives them statutory backing to try offences under the Act. The Supreme Court has treated speedy trial as a fundamental right under Article 21, and it has held that access to justice is a fundamental right under Articles 14 and 21. It has also held that no fixed time limit can be prescribed for concluding criminal trials, as that is neither feasible nor judicially permissible. The government has also set up a high-powered task force for strategic policy reforms. Initial Fast-Track Courts have been announced in High Courts where NEET-related cases are pending. Fast-Track Special Courts were set up under a Centrally Sponsored Scheme for rape and offences under the POCSO Act. The amendment also aims to ensure that examination fraud cases do not remain pending for prolonged periods. It introduces time-bound investigation and trial, and appeals before High Courts are to be heard by a two-judge Division Bench. Special Task Force powers under the Act are particularly relevant to inter-state paper-leak networks and organised criminal syndicates. The amended provisions are set out alongside the earlier law in a comparison table.

Q1.

In which year did the 11th Finance Commission first recommend Fast Track Courts to expedite the disposal of long-pending criminal cases?

Answer: _____

Q2.

In how many High Courts were initial Fast-Track Courts announced for pending NEET-related cases? (in number)

Answer: _____

Q3.

What is the combined timeline for investigation and trial under the amendment? (in months)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Which Supreme Court judgment of 2002 held that no fixed time limit can be prescribed for concluding criminal trials? Give the first-named party's name.

Answer: _____

Q5.

In which year were Fast-Track Special Courts set up under a Centrally Sponsored Scheme for rape and POCSO Act offences?

Answer: _____

Q6.

Within how many months must appeals before High Courts under the amended Act be disposed of? (in months)

Answer: _____

Vande Mataram history: recall

Vande Mataram is a patriotic song written by Bankim Chandra Chattopadhyay. It was composed as a response to British promotion of 'God Save the King', and it first appeared in a magazine in 1875. Later, the song became part of a novel in which warrior-monks sing it. The song praises Mother India through the image of a goddess, and its verses are divided into stanzas, with some verses in Sanskrit and the rest in Bengali.

After the Partition of Bengal in 1905, the song became closely linked with the national struggle. It was sung in public for the first time at Town Hall in Calcutta, and it soon became the customary opening song at a Congress session. An Indian flag bearing its words was also unfurled in Europe. Several tunes were composed for the song over the years, and it was sung at many national events.

Later, the national leadership had to decide how much of the song should be used at gatherings. After independence, the song was declared the National Song of India and was to be honoured equally with the National Anthem. The Constitution does not explicitly recognise a National Song. Its popularity and its official status therefore developed over several decades.

Q1.

In which year was Vande Mataram published in the novel Anandamath? (give the year)

Answer: _____

Q2.

How many stanzas does Vande Mataram have in total? (give the number)

Answer: _____

Q3.

Who sang Vande Mataram at the 1896 INC Session? (give the full name)

Answer: _____

Q4.

In which year did Bhikaji Cama unfurl an Indian flag inscribed with Vande Mataram at Stuttgart? (give the year)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Who sang Vande Mataram as the customary opening song at the 1905 Varanasi Congress Session? (give the name)

Answer: _____

Q6.

As per the 1937 Congress Working Committee decision, how many stanzas were to be used for national gatherings? (give the number)

Answer: _____

Q7.

After the Partition of Bengal, which movement did Vande Mataram become the rallying cry of? (give the name of the movement)

Answer: _____

National Green Tribunal: typed answer practice

The National Green Tribunal is a statutory body created under an Act of Parliament to deal with environmental disputes. Its objective is to provide relief and compensation for environmental damage, and its work rests on the polluter pays principle and the goal of sustainable development. India is one of the few countries to have set up a specialised environmental tribunal, and the NGT is the body through which such cases are heard. The Tribunal is headed by a Chairperson who is either a retired Supreme Court judge or a former Chief Justice of a High Court. Its members are of two kinds, judicial members and expert members, and the Central Government decides their exact number. The Tribunal has a principal place of sitting and also holds sittings at regional benches in several other cities. The NGT hears civil cases arising under a set of environmental laws, and it has original jurisdiction over civil cases with substantial environmental questions. It is guided by the principles of natural justice and is not bound by the Code of Civil Procedure. Its decisions can be executed as a decree of a civil court. Appeals against its orders can be taken to the Supreme Court, and the Tribunal must dispose of appeals within a fixed period from the date they are filed. Certain statutes, including a wildlife law and a forest rights law, are excluded from its jurisdiction.

Q1.

In which year was the statutory body National Green Tribunal established under the NGT Act? (year)

Answer: _____

Q2.

What is the principal place of sitting of the National Green Tribunal? (city)

Answer: _____

Q3.

How many regional benches does the National Green Tribunal have, apart from its principal place of sitting? (number)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Within how many months must the NGT dispose of appeals from the date of their filing? (in months)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Within how many days can an appeal be filed against an NGT decision in the Supreme Court? (in days)

Answer: _____

Q6.

In which year was the Forest Rights Act enacted, the law that the NGT excludes from its jurisdiction? (year)

Answer: _____

Q7.

The Central Government appoints the NGT Chairperson in consultation with which authority? (name the authority)

Answer: _____

Outlay and risk-sharing

Offshore hydrocarbon exploration needs large sums of public money before any oil or gas reaches the market. Surveys of the seabed, test drilling in deep water and the construction of shared facilities all require heavy spending. The government has therefore set aside a fixed amount for the scheme for a defined period. The money is divided among several heads, covering drilling, data collection, common infrastructure and manufacturing zones. Some of these heads are large and others are small, reflecting their different roles.

The government has also chosen to share part of the cost of drilling with companies that take part. This is meant to lower the financial risk that makes private firms hesitant about offshore work. The sharing applies only to eligible drilling costs. Officials expect that the combination of public allocations and shared risk will encourage firms to commit capital and bring technology to difficult frontier areas. The scheme's funding is therefore a central feature of its design.

Q1.

What is the total outlay approved for the scheme? (in crore)

Answer: _____

Q2.

What is the allocation for Common Offshore Infrastructure Hubs? (in crore)

Answer: _____

Q3.

What is the allocation for Oil & Gas Manufacturing and Services Zones? (in crore)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Up to what percentage of eligible drilling costs does the government support under the risk-sharing mechanism? (in per cent)

Answer: _____

Q5.

How many deepwater exploratory wells are included in the scheme's financial allocation? (number)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Up to which financial year is the scheme's implementation period? (give the year range)

Answer: _____

Q7.

What is the approximate annual natural production decline rate of existing oil and gas fields? (in per cent)

Answer: _____

Buddha's life and Buddhist teachings

Gautama Buddha was born as Siddhartha in a noble family near Kapilavastu, close to Lumbini in present-day Nepal. His father was an elected ruler, and his mother came from a royal dynasty of Kosala. Siddhartha left his home in a famous departure and later attained enlightenment, after which people began to call him the Buddha. He spent the rest of his life teaching, and his first sermon was delivered at Sarnath. Buddhism, which developed on the basis of his teachings in the sixth century BC, emphasises the attainment of enlightenment and recommends following a middle path between extremes. Its followers reject the authority of the Vedas and the idea of a permanent soul, which sets Buddhism apart from some other traditions. After the Buddha passed away, his teachings were recited and organised at a series of gatherings known as councils. The first council grouped the teachings into collections, which were later written down. Buddhist texts preserve these teachings in several collections, including the main discourses and the rules of conduct for monks and nuns. The core of his message concerns suffering, its causes, its ending and the path that leads to that ending, and this remains central to the faith. Each of these ideas connects with the others, and together they form the basis of the religion.

Q1.

In which year BC was Siddhartha, later Gautama Buddha, born? (number only)

Answer: _____

Q2.

In which year BC did Buddha die at Kushinagara? (number only)

Answer: _____

Q3.

What term did Buddha use to refer to himself, meaning one who has thus come or gone?

Answer: _____

Q4.

Into how many Pitakas were Buddha's teachings divided at the First Buddhist Council? (number only)

Answer: _____

Q5.

How many parts does the Atthanga Magga, the path to end suffering, have? (number only)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Which Noble Truth states that suffering could be ended? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q7.

Who chaired the First Buddhist Council? (name)

Answer: _____

Drought Policy Recall

Drought is one of the harder environmental problems to manage. For a long time, the usual response has been relief once the harm is done. A newer approach asks governments to look at how exposed they are before the damage occurs. To support this, a comprehensive technical instrument was introduced to help countries judge how prepared they are for drought. It draws on modern data-analysis tools, studies the vulnerability of communities and maps the risks they face. Money is the other side of the problem. Public funds can play a catalytic role, bringing in private and institutional investors to finance water security, climate-resilient farming and land restoration. A fresh pool of finance announced at the recent conference was meant for restoring land and building drought resilience in vulnerable countries. Discussions about a binding global instrument for drought form part of the wider debate. Land and water are closely linked. Overall, drought is best understood as a problem of preparation and investment, not only of emergency response.

Q1.

Along with UNCCD, which country launched the Drought Resilience Investment Facility (DRIF)? (answer in one word)

Answer: _____

Q2.

What does DRIF use public finance to do in order to attract private and institutional capital? (answer in one word)

Answer: _____

Q3.

What is the name of the new instrument introduced to assess national preparedness against drought?

Answer: _____

Q4.

Drought management is to shift from post-disaster relief towards which kind of planning? (answer in one word)

Answer: _____

Q5.

How much new and pipeline funding was announced for land restoration and drought resilience in vulnerable countries? (in USD billion)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Did countries reach consensus on a legally binding global agreement on drought at COP17? (yes or no)

Answer: _____

Q7.

From which COP onwards will drought receive a standalone agenda item? (give the COP number)

Answer: _____

Tiger reserves TITA set

In India, these areas are created under a national programme that gives them legal backing and dedicated management. Any change to a reserve's boundaries needs careful approval, because the rules are meant to protect the animals within them. Officials therefore treat reserve notification as a formal process, not a routine administrative step. Tiger reserves vary greatly in size, from Bor (Maharashtra), the smallest, to Nagarjunsagar Srisaïlam, the largest. Their tiger numbers are estimated through a periodic count carried out by official agencies with the help of research institutes. Counting takes place in fixed cycles, so that results from different years can be compared. Some states have many reserves while others have only a few. Software-based monitoring systems help managers track conditions in these reserves and respond to threats. The scale of this work is large, and even small changes in reserve boundaries can affect many animals. Together, these features explain why tiger reserves remain central to the country's conservation strategy.

Q1.

How many tiger reserves does India currently have? (in number)

Answer: _____

Q2.

Which state has the largest number of tiger reserves in India? (name of state)

Answer: _____

Q3.

Which tiger reserve has the highest tiger abundance in India? (name)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Which is the largest tiger reserve in India? (name)

Answer: _____

Q5.

What was India's tiger population in the 2022 figure? (in number)

Answer: _____

Q6.

In which year was Project Tiger launched? (year)

Answer: _____

Q7.

Which is the smallest tiger reserve in India? (name)

Answer: _____

Wetland Policy Tools

Protecting wetlands in India involves policy as well as science, and several central initiatives work through states and cities. One is a capacity building scheme run jointly by two ministries. Its aim is to encourage the optimal use of wetlands while enhancing biodiversity, carbon stock and eco-tourism. The scheme also seeks to generate income for local communities. Local communities are among the intended beneficiaries of the scheme. A second measure is the National Wetland Conservation Program, which is carried out through State Wetland Authorities. Later, a regulatory framework for wetlands was notified under a major environmental law. This framework

decentralises wetland management and provides for State or Union Territory Wetlands Authorities. Cities can also be recognised for wetland care. The Wetland City Accreditation Program is part of the Ramsar Convention. The Wetland City Accreditation Program promotes the conservation and wise use of urban and peri-urban wetlands. Accreditation is granted only to cities that satisfy all of the programme's international criteria. Protection is also linked with tourism. The government has announced a Nature-Culture Tourism Corridor in Uttar Pradesh, to be developed between two places. Mapping supports these efforts too. A national atlas of wetland decadal change, prepared by a national agency, tracks how wetlands have changed over time. Taken together, these steps reflect a move toward careful use of sensitive wetlands.

Q1.

What is the validity period of Wetland City accreditation? (in years)

Answer: _____

Q2.

In which year was the Wetland City Accreditation Program approved? (year)

Answer: _____

Q3.

Apart from MoEFCC, which ministry jointly runs the Amrit Dharohar Capacity Building Scheme?

Answer: _____

Q4.

In which year were the Wetlands (Conservation and Management) Rules notified? (year)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Which agency prepared the National Wetland Decadal Change Atlas? (acronym)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Apart from Ayodhya, which place in Uttar Pradesh is linked by the Nature-Culture Tourism Corridor?

Answer: _____

Q7.

Under the Amrit Dharohar scheme, tourism is to shift from high-volume tourism to what type of tourism? (three words)

Answer: _____

History of the Games: short answers

The idea of a sporting contest across the Commonwealth is older than the Games themselves. It can be traced to an event held in London in 1911, which formed part of a Festival of Empire organised during the coronation celebrations of King George V. The first edition of the Games was held in 1930 in a Canadian city, and the concept is credited to a sportswriter from the same country. The event was generally held once every four years, although the editions scheduled for 1942 and 1946 did not take place.

Over the decades the event has carried several different titles, and its name has changed more than once. Today the Games are organised by the Commonwealth Games Federation. India has hosted the Games, and its best performance at the Games, with 101 medals, came at that edition.

A centenary edition of the Games is planned for India in a future year, which will mark one hundred years since the first Games. India's first participation came decades before it hosted the Games,

showing a long link with the event. The Games are a multi-sport event in which athletes from many nations compete for medals across a range of sports.

Q1.

In which year was the event officially renamed the Commonwealth Games? (year)

Answer: _____

Q2.

In which city was the first edition of the Games held in 1930? (city name)

Answer: _____

Q3.

What was the original name of the Games when they were first held in 1930? (name of the event)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Which Canadian sportswriter is credited with the concept of the Games? (full name)

Answer: _____

Q5.

In which event did Canadian athlete Gordon Smallacombe win the first gold medal in the history of the Games?

Answer: _____

Q6.

In which year did India host the Commonwealth Games? (year)

Answer: _____

Q7.

In which year did India first participate in the Commonwealth Games? (year)

Answer: _____

Wildlife, index and energy

India's environment and energy policies in 2026 covered wildlife, waste and clean power. India observed World Elephant Day on 12 August, when new initiatives were announced for elephant conservation, including a regional action plan for southern states and a model conservation plan for the Nilgiri Elephant Reserve. Elephants are the largest land animals on Earth, and their conservation depends on reducing conflict with people. Scientists and officials use population studies and monitoring programmes to plan protection of the animals and their migratory routes. Lions also drew attention through Project Lion, which marked a rise in the Asiatic lion population and used software for individual identification of the animals.

On the environment front, India remained among the lowest-performing countries in the Environmental Performance Index, a biennial assessment of 177 countries. The index tracks environmental health, ecosystem vitality and climate change as its main policy objectives. Its air quality and biodiversity ranks were among the weakest, though climate change and sanitation showed some improvement.

For energy, the Cabinet approved a scheme to expand floating solar power linked with energy storage, to strengthen grid stability. The floating solar projects are a central sector scheme targeting 5,000 MW of capacity. A separate scheme, GOBARdhan, aims to convert organic waste into compressed biogas and bio-slurry. Together, these measures show how waste management and clean energy are being linked with the country's environmental goals.

Q1.

What was the estimated wild elephant population of India in the 2021-25 synchronous estimation? (in number)

Answer: _____

Q2.

What rank did India get among 177 countries in the Environmental Performance Index 2026? (rank number)

Answer: _____

Q3.

What was the Asiatic lion population in 2025? (in number)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Which country topped the Environmental Performance Index 2026?

Answer: _____

Q5.

In which year was the Gir Wildlife Sanctuary established?

Answer: _____

Q6.

On which river is the Omkareshwar Floating Solar Park located?

Answer: _____

Q7.

How many Elephant Reserves does India have? (in number)

Answer: _____

Dirac Medal: recall

The Dirac Medal is an annual award named after the physicist Paul Dirac, whose legacy it is meant to honour. Dirac was one of the founders of modern quantum mechanics, and the medal is a tribute to his place in that history. The 2026 edition of the award went to the Indian physicist Dhar, who shared it with other scientists. The honour was given for pioneering work in statistical mechanics, which is the field of the group's research. Each recipient of the medal receives a cash prize along with the medal itself. The award is presented every year, and the 2026 edition is the one described here. The item is part of the AILET Corner in the August 2026 current affairs section, and its facts should be read as a set. Candidates revising this item should link the physicist's name, the field of the work and the name of the award. A short written summary, with each detail on its own line, makes these facts easier to recall before an examination. Repeated practice with the same facts also helps in answering questions that test a detail not stated in the passage. The passage therefore gives the context of the award, while the exact figures are left for the reader to recall from the booklet.

Q1.

In which year was the Dirac Medal instituted? (year)

Answer: _____

Q2.

What cash prize, in US dollars, does each recipient receive along with the medal? (number only)

Answer: _____

Q3.

In which year did Paul Dirac receive the Nobel Prize in Physics? (year)

Answer: _____

Q4.

With which physicist did Paul Dirac share his Nobel Prize in Physics? (surname only)

Answer: _____

Q5.

What is the full name of the Indian physicist who won the 2026 Dirac Medal?

Answer: _____

Q6.

How many physicists, including Dhar, shared the 2026 Dirac Medal? (number)

Answer: _____

Refugee Law Terms and Instruments

The booklet separates three groups of people on the move: refugees, asylum seekers and migrants. Each group differs in the reason for moving, the protection it can receive and the law that governs its stay. A refugee is a person who is forced to flee because of persecution or conflict. The Refugee Convention is described as a comprehensive attempt to define refugees, and it sets guidelines for host countries to protect refugees and preserve their rights. An asylum seeker is a person who seeks recognition as a refugee. A migrant moves mainly for work, education or better opportunities rather than to escape danger. The booklet also refers to other international instruments that concern people on the move, including a framework that builds on a human rights declaration. The three categories also appear in the booklet's coverage of the Ceuta Migration Crisis, in which nearly 60000 migrants attempted to enter the Spanish enclave from Morocco in July 2026. Ceuta lies on the northern coast of Africa and borders Morocco. Refugees, asylum seekers and migrants are all people on the move, but the booklet treats each category as distinct in law. The booklet presents the three terms in a simple layout, with a short list of features under each heading.

Q1.

In which year was the Refugee Convention adopted, the instrument the booklet calls a comprehensive attempt to define refugees? (year)

Answer: _____

Q2.

What term does the booklet give to the principle that refugees cannot be forcibly returned? (term)

Answer: _____

Q3.

Which Article of the Universal Declaration of Human Rights affirms the right to seek asylum from persecution? (article number)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Which category of people does the booklet say does not qualify for refugee status? (two words)

Answer: _____

Q5.

What is the name of the instrument that removed geographic and time limits on refugee protection? (name)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Which convention advocates for refugee children's welfare? (name)

Answer: _____

Q7.

According to the booklet, migrants may migrate legally or what? (one word)

Answer: _____

Dates and Names in the Western Sahara Context

Ceuta and Melilla are Spanish territories on the North African mainland, and the booklet notes that they are not the only Spanish holdings in the region. Spain exercises sovereignty over these territories, which are described as exclaves. Morocco, the neighbouring country, has a long-standing position on their status that the booklet records. Western Sahara is a separate territory in the same region, and the booklet describes it as a former Spanish colony. Several parties have offered different proposals for its future. The booklet connects the migration issue at Ceuta with this wider dispute. It also says that Spain's relations with its neighbours have affected the flow of people through Ceuta over time. The booklet reports that nearly 60000 migrants attempted to enter Ceuta from Morocco in July 2026, and it places that event within this regional picture. The booklet's coverage of this topic appears in its current affairs section for August 2026, under the heading International Relations and News. Ceuta and Melilla are described as Spanish exclaves, and Western Sahara is discussed in the same section as the crisis. The crisis was declared resolved through cooperation between Spain and Morocco.

Q1.

In which year did Morocco gain independence, the year from which it has sought the return of these territories? (year)

Answer: _____

Q2.

In which year was Western Sahara annexed by Morocco? (year)

Answer: _____

Q3.

In which year did the Polisario Front declare the Sahrawi Arab Democratic Republic? (year)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Which country supports the Polisario Front? (country)

Answer: _____

Q5.

What arrangement does Morocco propose for Western Sahara under its own sovereignty? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Which movement demands self-determination for the Sahrawi people? (name)

Answer: _____

UNHCR Dates and Indian Statutes

The United Nations High Commissioner for Refugees, known as UNHCR, is the UN body that works to protect refugees and displaced people. It was formed as a successor to an earlier organisation set up after the Second World War. The UNHCR's headquarters are in a Swiss city, and its stated aim is to protect the rights of people fleeing conflict and persecution and to secure a better future

for them. The organisation has received the Nobel Peace Prize twice. It also presents an annual award for exceptional service to refugees, displaced or stateless people. In India, undocumented foreigners are regulated under several Acts, which include laws on foreigners, passports and citizenship. The booklet also refers to the International Covenant on Civil and Political Rights, which safeguards individuals from torture or inhuman treatment upon return. World Refugee Day falls on June 20, and its 2026 theme is Until Everyone Is Safe. The booklet also lists the Indira Gandhi Prize alongside the Nobel Peace Prize among the honours received by UNHCR. Its coverage of UNHCR and Indian statutes appears in the current affairs section for August 2026.

Q1.

In which year did the office of the High Commissioner for Refugees originate under the League of Nations? (year)

Answer: _____

Q2.

In which year was UNHCR formed? (year)

Answer: _____

Q3.

Which Act regulating undocumented foreigners in India was enacted in 1939? (name)

Answer: _____

Q4.

In which year did UNHCR first receive the Nobel Peace Prize? (year)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Who led the League of Nations office for refugees whose origins UNHCR traces? (name)

Answer: _____

Q6.

In which city are UNHCR's headquarters located? (city)

Answer: _____

Q7.

In which year was the Citizenship Act passed? (year)

Answer: _____

Seas, Straits and Neighbours

The South China Sea is located in the Pacific region and lies alongside the mainland of South-East Asia. A number of countries surround its waters, and the sea connects with neighbouring seas through passages at its edges. Ships that travel through these passages move between the sea and the wider waters beyond it. The sea lies in a maritime zone that is heavily trafficked, and a large portion of global trade passes through that zone. Beneath its seabed are oil and gas deposits, and its waters support rich fishing grounds. Several islands within the sea are claimed by more than one country, and these overlapping claims have made the waters a site of long-running disputes. The sea's position matters for trade, energy and fishing, as well as for the governments whose coastlines face it. The interpretation of the international law of the sea remains fiercely disputed in this region. Routes through the passages carry a steady flow of commercial traffic. Its islands include several groups, and the booklet names them while describing the disputes. Its waters are shared by a number of governments, each of which has its own position on how the sea should be used. The sea therefore sits at the centre of questions about trade, energy and fishing.

Q1.

Which strait links the South China Sea with the Philippine Sea? (name the strait)

Answer: _____

Q2.

Which sea does the Taiwan Strait link the South China Sea with? (name the sea)

Answer: _____

Q3.

Which ocean is the South China Sea described as an arm of? (name the ocean)

Answer: _____

Q4.

How many countries does the booklet list as bordering the sea? (give the number in figures)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Which bordering country is listed first in the booklet's list of bordering countries? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Which bordering country is listed last in the booklet's list of bordering countries? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q7.

Which bordering country is listed third in the booklet's list of bordering countries? (one word)

Answer: _____

Estimates and Shares

Beneath the sea's floor lie deposits of oil and natural gas, and estimates of their size have been published by an agency of the United States government. The sea is part of a maritime zone that is heavily trafficked, and a large share of global commerce moves across it. Goods carried by ship through these waters travel between many ports, which makes the routes economically important. An international body that studies trade has also published figures on the share of world trade that passes through the sea. The sea's resources and routes are therefore valuable to the states around it. The waters have been the subject of long-running disputes, and several islands within them are claimed by more than one state. The disputes concern both the islands and the waters around them, and the sea also carries a large share of the world's shipping trade. Taken together, the resources, fishing grounds and shipping routes explain why the sea draws so much attention in international news. The booklet places these figures alongside its account of the sea's islands and disputes. The figures are reported as estimates, so they describe approximate amounts rather than exact totals.

Q1.

How much oil, in billion barrels, is estimated to lie in deposits under the sea? (number)

Answer: _____

Q2.

How much natural gas, in trillion cubic feet, is estimated in deposits under the sea? (number)

Answer: _____

Q3.

What share of the world's fisheries does the sea contain, in percent? (number)

Answer: _____

Q4.

What share of global trade passes through the sea, in percent? (number)

Answer: _____

Q5.

What is the estimated value of global trade passing through the sea, in trillion dollars? (number)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Which United States agency estimated the oil and gas deposits? (acronym)

Answer: _____

Q7.

Which United Nations body estimated the share of global trade passing through the sea? (acronym)

Answer: _____

Claims and India's Stake

The South China Sea contains many islands, reefs and shoals, and several of them are claimed by more than one state. The claims overlap in several places, which means that the sea has been the focus of disputes for many years. One island group in the sea has been under the effective control of a single state since a battle fought in the 1970s, though other states still assert claims to it. A shoal near the Philippines has also been contested by several governments, and its status changed after a standoff. The islands and the waters around them are therefore part of a complex set of claims. The booklet notes that the claimant states have taken different positions on how the disputes should be settled. It also records that China has preferred bilateral negotiations with the other parties involved. Freedom of navigation and regional stability are important themes in the debate, and the booklet explains how these themes affect the countries that depend on the sea for their commerce. The overlapping claims shape the way the sea is governed, and each state's position affects the position of the others. These disputes have continued for a long time. Their history explains why the sea remains a focus of attention.

Q1.

In which year did a standoff give China de facto control over the Scarborough region? (year)

Answer: _____

Q2.

China has held the Paracel Islands de facto since 1974, following a battle involving which country? (name the country)

Answer: _____

Q3.

Which group of islands is claimed by five states, including Brunei? (name the group, two words)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Which shoal is claimed by the Philippines, China and Taiwan? (name the shoal, two words)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Which island group is claimed by China, Taiwan and Vietnam? (name the group, two words)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Apart from the South China Sea, through which strait does a significant share of India's maritime commerce pass? (name the strait)

Answer: _____

Straw Polls and Permanent Member Signals

The Security Council has held a second round of informal straw polls to identify a potential successor to Antonio Guterres. His second term as UN Secretary-General is scheduled to conclude on 31 December 2026, so the selection is taking place as that date approaches. Straw polls form one stage in narrowing the field before the Council formally recommends a candidate to the United Nations General Assembly. Nominees also take part in interactive dialogues with Member States, where they discuss their vision for the United Nations and respond to questions from stakeholders. During a straw poll, each Council member records a position on each candidate. The polls are not the final decision, because the Council's recommendation is one part of a longer procedure that is completed when the General Assembly acts on it. Guterres's term is the reason the process is taking place now, and the Council must work through each stage before a recommendation can be made. The booklet presents this as a key stage in the process, one that comes before any decision taken by the General Assembly.

Q1.

Permanent Members use what type of ballot in subsequent straw poll rounds? (name the ballot type)

Answer: _____

Q2.

Which response indicates that a member supports or favours a candidate? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q3.

Straw poll rounds continue until a candidate demonstrates what? (two words)

Answer: _____

Q4.

What do straw polls assess? (two words)

Answer: _____

Q5.

A Discourage from a Permanent Member effectively signals what in a formal vote? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Straw polls are informal and confidential what exercises? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q7.

Which response means a member has not taken a position? (two words)

Answer: _____

UNSC Structure and the Veto

The Council is responsible for maintaining international peace and security, and it is among the principal organs of the United Nations. The booklet describes the Council as the apex of that structure, which places it at the centre of the organisation's work. Its membership is arranged so that different members have different roles. Permanent Members have a distinct place in the Council, and the booklet treats their position as central to how decisions are reached. The booklet

argues that the Council's structure has not kept pace with the present world. It also connects the Council's current shape to the period in which the Council was created. For the Council to act on a matter, the arrangements that govern its decisions must allow a decision to pass, and the booklet examines whether those arrangements still serve the present international order. The discussion is therefore about how the Council is built, who sits in it, and how its decisions can be stopped or carried forward.

Q1.

The five Permanent Members gained permanent membership because they won which war? (name the war)

Answer: _____

Q2.

Whose veto left the UNSC powerless during the Russia-Ukraine conflict? (name the country)

Answer: _____

Q3.

How many votes does each UNSC member have? (answer in words)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Can a retiring member be re-elected immediately? (answer yes or no)

Answer: _____

Q5.

The UNSC is one of how many principal organs of the UN? (answer in words)

Answer: _____

Q6.

The five Permanent Members hold veto power in which UN organ? (name the organ)

Answer: _____

Cauvery River and its basin: Practice TITA

The conflict over the Cauvery is between states that share the river's water but depend on it for different purposes. Karnataka, the upper riparian state, has sought more water for drinking needs in its major city and for irrigation. Tamil Nadu, the lower riparian state, has sought dependable releases of water for farming in its delta. The roots of the dispute lie in an agreement reached between the Madras Presidency and the princely state of Mysore. Madras opposed Mysore's plans to widen irrigation and to build storage structures on the river. After the states became successor states, the issue continued to be a major source of contention. The matter was taken up under the Constitution and a central statute, and a tribunal was later constituted to settle the sharing of water. The river has several major dams, and its basin is divided into an upper part and a lower part. These details show why each state's claim follows from its position on the river, and why the dispute has lasted so long. The states' claims are therefore not abstract. Karnataka's position as the upper riparian state and Tamil Nadu's position as the lower riparian state each shape what the two governments ask for from the river, and each state's demands are set against the other's. Keeping these positions in mind makes the later facts about the river much easier to follow.

Q1.

The Cauvery is called the 'Ganga of the ____' in the text. Fill in the blank with one word.

Answer: _____

Q2.

Near which place does the Cauvery drain into the Bay of Bengal? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q3.

Which major dam on the Cauvery is located in Karnataka? (name of the dam)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Which monsoon does the Upper Basin of the Cauvery receive? (name of the monsoon)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Which monsoon benefits the Lower Basin of the Cauvery? (name of the monsoon)

Answer: _____

Q6.

In which Karnataka district does the Cauvery originate, at Talakaveri? (district name)

Answer: _____

Mekedatu project and the latest order: Practice TITA

The Cauvery dispute is shaped by the positions of the states along the river. Karnataka is the upper riparian state, while Tamil Nadu is the lower riparian state. Tamil Nadu seeks assured releases of water for agriculture in the Cauvery delta. The dispute has a long history, going back to an agreement of 1892 between the Madras Presidency and the princely state of Mysore. Madras objected when Mysore planned to expand irrigation on the river. In the present phase, two developments have drawn attention. A regulatory body on the river has endorsed an order concerning the release of water from Karnataka to Tamil Nadu. Separately, Karnataka has put forward the Mekedatu Balancing Reservoir Project on the Cauvery River. Projects of this kind can affect how much water flows downstream to the lower riparian state. The river also has several major dams, which are part of the water system the states share. The sections above describe the states' positions, the historical agreement, and the two developments that have drawn attention to the dispute. Each development is connected to the wider conflict over how the water of the river is shared between the two states, and both are described separately above so that their details can be kept apart.

Q1.

How many Cusecs of Cauvery water did the endorsed order direct Karnataka to release to Tamil Nadu? (number in Cusecs)

Answer: _____

Q2.

In which year did Tamil Nadu raise objections against the Mekedatu project? (year)

Answer: _____

Q3.

Approximately how many MW of power is the Mekedatu project expected to generate? (number in MW)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Which court did Tamil Nadu approach over the Mekedatu project? (two words)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Which city does the Mokedatu project aim to supply drinking water to? (name of the city)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Approximately how many TMC ft is 3,500 Cusecs equivalent to, as stated in the order? (number in TMC ft)

Answer: _____

Identity and Economic Concerns

The Gorkhaland issue concerns a demand for a separate political or administrative arrangement for the Gorkha population of the Darjeeling Hills in West Bengal. Supporters of the movement say that the people of the hills have their own language, culture and social character, and that these set them apart from the wider population of the state. Much of the case therefore rests on the idea of a distinct identity. Beyond identity, the movement has raised questions of dignity and representation. Such concerns have been present for a long time, and they continue to shape how the debate is framed. Economic concerns form a second strand of the argument. Demands for greater control over decisions and public money are closely tied to these grievances. Supporters also point out that the region contributes to the state's economy through its natural and commercial activities. The movement has a long history. Its early political demands can be traced to the start of the twentieth century, and the agitation that followed gave the movement great momentum. Today the discussion centres on how governance, finance and development should be organised for the hill region within the existing constitutional system.

Q1.

Which language is predominantly spoken in the Darjeeling Hills region? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q2.

Concerns over identity insecurity and which other factor have contributed to demands for stronger political recognition? (two words)

Answer: _____

Q3.

Along with Forestry and Tourism, which product of the region is named as a contribution? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Besides political autonomy, insufficient which kind of autonomy is listed as a concern? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Proponents seek recognition of the community as an integral part of which country? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q6.

The Darjeeling Hills identity is described as distinct from which plains population? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q7.

The supporters' basis of demand built on language and culture is titled 'Ethno-' what? (one word)

Answer: _____

NEET-UG 2024 leak and the 2024 Act: typed answers

The NEET-UG 2024 controversy drew national attention after a paper leak was alleged in the examination. Alleged leak networks were reported in Patna and Hazaribagh, and the case showed how a question paper could be compromised before the test was held. Both places were linked to these alleged networks. Candidates in the examination were affected, and the controversy drew attention across the country. A group of candidates secured full marks, and the way those results were produced became a key point of dispute. Investigations later exposed organised cheating syndicates that had worked to compromise the examination process. Monitoring by the Supreme Court kept the case under close watch while the investigations continued. In response, Parliament passed the Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act in 2024. The Act applies to major public examinations, including tests held by national-level recruitment and testing bodies. It is meant to deal with paper leaks, organised cheating and other forms of fraud connected with examinations. The law was therefore passed after the controversy had exposed these problems. The Act was thus a legal answer to the problems that the NEET-UG case had revealed. Its title shows that its focus is on unfair means in public examinations.

Q1.

How many candidates secured full marks in the NEET-UG 2024 examination?

Answer: _____

Q2.

In which Indian state is Hazaribagh, one of the places where alleged leak networks were reported in the NEET-UG 2024 case?

Answer: _____

Q3.

In which Indian state is Patna, one of the places where alleged leak networks were reported in the NEET-UG 2024 case?

Answer: _____

Q4.

Which testing body's examinations are among those covered by the Act? Give its full name.

Answer: _____

Q5.

The Act is described as India's first dedicated legislation of which level of government? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Besides stronger deterrence, what did the 2026 controversy intensify demands for? (three words)

Answer: _____

Special Task Force and task force reforms: typed answers

The Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024 followed a controversy over the NEET-UG 2024 examination, in which alleged paper leaks were reported in Patna and Hazaribagh. A group of candidates secured full marks in the same examination, and the outcome led to protests across the country. Investigations and monitoring by the Supreme Court followed. The Act is described as India's first dedicated central legislation on paper leaks, organised cheating and exam-related fraud. The Act covers major public examinations, including those conducted by UPSC and SSC. It includes a provision for a Special Task Force that can be set up to investigate offences under the law. Such a force is meant for specialised investigation and is linked to the Act's enforcement. The government has also constituted a high-powered task force to look into examination matters at a broader level. The high-powered task force is a separate body from the Special Task Force. The 2026 amendment, which Parliament has passed, adds further provisions to

the framework created by the 2024 Act. The controversy that preceded the Act was widely followed, and the new provisions respond to demands for faster legal proceedings. Alleged leaks were the subject of investigation, and the NEET-UG case remained a reference point for the debate on examination fraud.

Q1.

Nandan Nilekani is a Co-Founder of which company?

Answer: _____

Q2.

Nandan Nilekani is the Founding Chairman of which authority? Give the full name.

Answer: _____

Q3.

Which authority is empowered to establish a Special Task Force for investigating offences under the Act? (two words)

Answer: _____

Q4.

The Special Task Force is particularly relevant to which kind of paper-leak networks? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Apart from paper-leak networks, the Special Task Force is also relevant to which other type of group? (three words)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Who chairs the high-powered task force? Give the surname.

Answer: _____

Anthem, Song and the Constitution

India's two national songs have different legal and symbolic positions. Jana Gana Mana is the National Anthem and carries full official recognition as a national symbol. Vande Mataram is the National Song, a status it was given after independence, although the Constitution does not explicitly provide for a national song at all. Respect for national symbols is part of civic life. Parliament reflects the same respect in its own practice, since its sittings are opened with the anthem. Vande Mataram has a long history in public life. It appeared in the Bengali novel Anandamath and was composed as a patriotic response to a British promotion of a song. The song praises Mother India through an image of a goddess. A 2026 amendment proposal would extend legal protection to Vande Mataram. Under the proposal, intentionally insulting the song or preventing its singing would become punishable. The stated aim is to give the song statutory protection comparable to what the anthem already enjoys, bringing the national song into the same legal framework as the flag and the anthem.

Q1.

On what date was Jana Gana Mana adopted as the National Anthem? (give the full date)

Answer: _____

Q2.

Under which Article of the Constitution are the fundamental duties to respect the National Flag and National Anthem listed? (give the article number with its letter)

Answer: _____

Q3.

Who declared Vande Mataram as the National Song of India? (give the full name)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Who composed the tune of Jana Gana Mana? (give the name)

Answer: _____

Q5.

In which year was Jana Gana Mana composed? (give the year)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Vande Mataram was composed as a patriotic response to the British promotion of which song? (give the song's name)

Answer: _____

Q7.

At which venue was Vande Mataram first publicly used on 7 August 1905? (give the venue)

Answer: _____

Tribunals and Ordinary Courts

The Income Tax Appellate Tribunal, established in 1941, is described as the first tribunal in India. It was set up to reduce court workload, expedite adjudication of disputes and build expertise on tax matters. Tribunals in general aim to adjudicate specialised disputes, and they operate in fields such as taxation, company law, environment and telecommunications. The Lok Sabha has passed the Tribunals Reforms Bill 2026 to establish a National Tribunals Commission for unified tribunal governance. The Bill seeks to replace the Tribunals Reforms Act 2021 and to re-enact provisions that were struck down. Its framework aims at a common institutional structure for tribunals, with a national tribunals data grid among its functions. The National Green Tribunal aims at relief and compensation for environmental damage, and its work rests on the polluter pays principle and on sustainable development. It hears civil cases under seven laws and is guided by the principles of natural justice. Its decisions can be executed as a decree of a civil court, and tribunal decisions in general remain subject to scrutiny by the concerned High Court. The Supreme Court's role is reflected in *Madras Bar Association v. Union of India* (2010-2025), which repeatedly scrutinised certain provisions relating to tribunals.

Q1.

Which quality is described as a crucial requirement for judges in a court of law? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q2.

Tribunals have power to try special cases defined by which legal instrument? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q3.

Civil courts have judicial authority over suits of a civil nature, unless what? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q4.

How does the booklet classify tribunals by type? (two words)

Answer: _____

Q5.

A tribunal President or member may not be legally trained but may be an expert in which field? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q6.

What word describes judges of ordinary courts regarding their tenure, terms and conditions of service? (one word)

Answer: _____

Constitutional Framework for Tribunals

The Income Tax Appellate Tribunal, established in 1941, is described as the first tribunal in India, and it was set up to reduce court workload, expedite adjudication of disputes and build expertise on tax matters. Tribunals in general aim to adjudicate specialised disputes and reduce the workload of constitutional courts. They operate in fields such as taxation, company law, environment, telecommunications, armed forces and administrative matters. The National Green Tribunal aims at giving relief and compensation for environmental damage, and it works on the polluter pays principle and sustainable development. It hears civil cases under seven laws and is guided by the principles of natural justice. Its decisions can be executed as a decree of a civil court. The Lok Sabha has passed the Tribunals Reforms Bill 2026, which seeks to establish a National Tribunals Commission for unified tribunal governance. The Bill seeks to replace the Tribunals Reforms Act 2021, and it deals with the selection of tribunal chairpersons and members, performance review of members and maintaining a national tribunals data grid. Tribunal decisions remain subject to scrutiny by the concerned High Court. The Supreme Court's role is reflected in *Madras Bar Association v. Union of India* (2010-2025), which repeatedly scrutinised certain provisions relating to tribunals.

Q1.

In which year was Part XIV-A inserted into the Constitution by the 42nd Amendment? (year)

Answer: _____

Q2.

Which Part of the Constitution, inserted by the 42nd Amendment, contains the provisions for setting up tribunals? (Part name)

Answer: _____

Q3.

Which Article empowers Parliament alone to establish Administrative Tribunals? (article number)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Which case decided in 1997 held that judicial review under Articles 226/227 and Article 32 is part of the Basic Structure? (name of the first party)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Which body recommended Civil Services Tribunals at the national and state levels? (name or abbreviation)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Apart from Parliament, which bodies can establish tribunals under Article 323B? (two words)

Answer: _____

Q7.

Article 323B allows tribunals to be set up for which kind of matters? (one word)

Answer: _____

Scheme Overview Facts

Samudra Manthan is the name of a scheme that the booklet presents as a National Offshore Exploration Scheme. Its subject is exploration beneath the sea, with its attention directed to deep waters and to frontier areas. The booklet places the scheme in its August 2026 current affairs coverage, under the heading of polity and governance. It describes the scheme's name, its focus and the broad areas it covers, and it presents those areas as parts of a single plan. The scheme is also linked in the booklet to India's energy position, because offshore work is seen as one way of strengthening the country's supply of oil and gas. The description moves from the scheme's name to its focus, and then to its place in the wider energy picture. Readers are given a short account of the scheme's purpose, its planned areas and the setting in which it has been announced. The booklet keeps this description short, so the scheme is introduced through its name, its focus and its link to energy before any further detail is given.

Q1.

Which body approved the Samudra Manthan Scheme?

Answer: _____

Q2.

Under which category of scheme does the Samudra Manthan Scheme fall? (give the category name)

Answer: _____

Q3.

What is the upper end, in years, of the typical gestation period of offshore projects? (in years)

Answer: _____

Q4.

What is the upper end of the approximate cost of a deepwater exploratory well? (in US\$ million)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Which ministry is implementing the Samudra Manthan Scheme?

Answer: _____

Q6.

Which priority offshore basin has a name that begins with the word Krishna? (name the basin)

Answer: _____

Q7.

Which key component of the scheme is focused on shared production and evacuation infrastructure? (name the component)

Answer: _____

Deep Ocean Mission Figures

India's Deep Ocean Mission is a national programme focused on the deep sea. A government ministry leads the programme, which is described as having a defined budget and a set period of time. One of its main missions is Samudrayaan, which aims to explore the bed of the ocean. The mission is described as India's flagship deep ocean effort, and it is planned as a crewed mission that takes people into the deep sea.

The mission uses a submersible called Matsya6000, which is described as India's premier human submersible for deep-sea exploration. The vehicle is built from titanium alloy and is designed to withstand very high pressure at depth. It carries a set of scientific tools for observation, sample collection and experiments, and it moves through the water using underwater thrusters.

The booklet describes the programme, the mission and the vehicle as parts of one effort. Its account moves from the programme's overall purpose to the particular mission and then to the equipment used in it. The description is brief, but it gives a clear picture of how the three elements fit together. The mission is presented as one of the programme's main missions, and the submersible is presented as the means by which that mission carries out its work.

Q1.

Which ministry spearheads the Deep Ocean Mission? (name the ministry)

Answer: _____

Q2.

In which year was the Deep Ocean Mission approved?

Answer: _____

Q3.

What is the budget of the Deep Ocean Mission in crore rupees over five years? (in crore rupees)

Answer: _____

Q4.

How many aquanauts can Matsya6000 accommodate? (number)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Up to how many hours can Matsya6000's operating endurance be expanded in emergencies? (in hours)

Answer: _____

Q6.

To what depth in metres does the crewed Samudrayaan expedition aim to reach? (in metres)

Answer: _____

Q7.

At what speed in km/hr does Matsya6000 travel using underwater thrusters? (in km/hr)

Answer: _____

Sarnath and India's listed sites

Sarnath is an ancient Buddhist site that has been inscribed on the UNESCO World Heritage List. The site is associated with the first sermon that Gautama Buddha delivered after attaining enlightenment at Bodhgaya. That event is linked to the beginning of the Buddhist Sangha and to the establishment of the Noble Eightfold Path.

Sarnath is one of four principal Buddhist pilgrimage sites. Its features include the Chaukhandi Stupa, which is associated with the meeting of Buddha and his first five disciples. The Dharmarajika Stupa is traditionally associated with Emperor Ashoka and Buddha's relics, and the Mulagandhakuti Vihara is linked with Buddha's rainy-season retreat.

A place on the list is one that UNESCO has listed for its cultural or physical significance. The World Heritage List classifies places as cultural, natural or mixed. India has one mixed heritage site on

the list, and the list also includes cultural and natural sites from the country.

The World Heritage Committee administers the list and meets in annual sessions. India has hosted one of these sessions, and India has also served as a member of the Committee. The Committee takes decisions on sites after the expert assessments are complete. The list is maintained by the World Heritage Programme.

Q1.

In which Indian state is the Ancient Buddhist Site of Sarnath located? (state name)

Answer: _____

Q2.

In which year were the Taj Mahal, Agra Fort, Ajanta and Ellora Caves inscribed on the World Heritage List? (year)

Answer: _____

Q3.

Which is the only Indus Valley Civilization site from India on the World Heritage List? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q4.

In which Indian state is Dholavira located? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q5.

In which Indian state is Khangchendzonga National Park, India's mixed heritage site, located? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Where did India host the 46th Annual Session of the World Heritage Committee? (name of the venue)

Answer: _____

Q7.

For which term did India serve as a Committee Member of the World Heritage Committee? (years, e.g. 2000-2005)

Answer: _____

UNESCO, the treaty and the recognition process

UNESCO is an organisation that works in education, science and culture, and its name reflects these three fields. The World Heritage List is maintained by the World Heritage Programme, and places on the list are recognised for their cultural or physical significance.

The List is based on an international treaty known as the Convention concerning Protection of World Cultural and Natural Heritage. Countries become party to the treaty through ratification. In India, a government body is the nodal agency for World Heritage matters.

Proposed sites go through a review by expert organisations before the final stage of recognition. The World Heritage Committee administers the list. Sites on the list fall into cultural, natural and mixed categories. Other UNESCO efforts include the Memory of the World Register, the Man and Biosphere Programme and Intangible Cultural Heritage.

The World Heritage Committee is the body that takes decisions on the list, while the expert

organisations provide assessments that inform those decisions. The recognition of a place on the list therefore rests on the treaty, the review by expert bodies and the Committee's decision. Sarnath's recent inscription followed this structure, which is the framework in which recognition operates. The list is maintained, and sites are recognised, under the framework described above.

Q1.

In which year was UNESCO founded? (year)

Answer: _____

Q2.

In which city is UNESCO's headquarters located? (city)

Answer: _____

Q3.

In which year was the World Heritage Convention adopted by UNESCO? (year)

Answer: _____

Q4.

In which year did the World Heritage Convention formally take effect? (year)

Answer: _____

Q5.

In which year did India ratify the World Heritage Convention? (year)

Answer: _____

Q6.

What is the acronym of the nodal agency in India for UNESCO World Heritage matters? (acronym)

Answer: _____

Q7.

Which two bodies assess sites before the World Heritage Committee's final decision? (two acronyms joined by and)

Answer: _____

COP17 Finance and Partnership Facts

The United Nations Convention to Combat Desertification is one of three Rio Conventions, along with the UNFCCC and the CBD. It was adopted on 17 June 1994, a date now observed as World Day to Combat Desertification. It is the principal international legally binding framework dealing with desertification, land degradation and drought, and its core objective is to promote sustainable land management. The convention aims to achieve land degradation neutrality by 2030, a goal linked with SDG Target 15.3.

The seventeenth Conference of the Parties concluded in Ulaanbaatar, Mongolia, under the theme 'Restoring Land. Restoring Hope.' The meeting coincided with the UN International Year of Rangelands and Pastoralists 2026, which placed greater emphasis on pastoral communities and sustainable rangeland management.

Land degradation has emerged as a major threat to ecosystems, agriculture and economic stability. The convention has built platforms that bring together public money and private investors. One of these is a drought partnership that was launched at an earlier COP and aims to help countries that are vulnerable to drought. Another is a major platform through which the convention involves the private sector in land-related work.

COP17 also promoted several approaches that rely on healthy ecosystems. Mongolia highlighted

the severity of its own land degradation challenge during the meeting.

Q1.

In which year was the Riyadh Global Drought Resilience Partnership launched? (give the year)

Answer: _____

Q2.

How much in commitments did the Riyadh Global Drought Resilience Partnership initially secure? (in USD billion)

Answer: _____

Q3.

How many vulnerable and drought-affected countries does the Riyadh partnership aim to support? (give the number)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Which UNCCD platform is its major means of involving the private sector in land-related work? (give the name)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Rather than isolated interventions, what kind of restoration does the booklet say the land degradation crisis highlights the need for? (two words)

Answer: _____

Q6.

COP17 promoted greater adoption of which type of solutions? (two words)

Answer: _____

India at COP17: Targets and Missions

The United Nations Convention to Combat Desertification is one of three Rio Conventions, along with the UNFCCC and the CBD. It is the principal international legally binding framework dealing with desertification, land degradation and drought. Its core objective is to promote sustainable land management, and it is linked with SDG Target 15.3.

Land degradation neutrality describes a condition in which the quantity and quality of land resources needed to support ecosystem functions and services remain stable or improve.

The most recent conference of the Parties was held in Ulaanbaatar, Mongolia, under the theme 'Restoring Land. Restoring Hope.' It coincided with the UN International Year of Rangelands and Pastoralists 2026, which placed greater emphasis on pastoral communities and sustainable rangeland management.

Land degradation has emerged as a major threat to ecosystems, agriculture and economic stability. Mongolia highlighted the severity of its own land degradation challenge during the meeting. The booklet describes an objective of using healthy ecosystems as a means of strengthening climate and drought resilience.

India attended the meeting and presented its own work on land. India also runs several national programmes that address land degradation, which the booklet describes as part of its own land efforts. The meeting also promoted greater use of nature-based approaches, which relate to ecosystems and development planning.

Q1.

In which year was India's National Action Plan to Combat Desertification introduced? (give the year)

Answer: _____

Q2.

In which year was that National Action Plan revised? (give the year)

Answer: _____

Q3.

How many million hectares of degraded and deforested land has India brought under restoration under the Bonn Challenge? (give the number in million hectares)

Answer: _____

Q4.

By which year is India's broader target of restoring 26 million hectares to be reached? (give the year)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Which mission focuses on the creation and rejuvenation of water bodies? (give the name)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Which desert is among the ecosystems that India's grassland guide seeks to conserve? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q7.

At which UNCCD conference did India launch its Guide to Grasslands and Other Open Natural Ecosystems? (give the COP number)

Answer: _____

Global Initiatives: IUCN, NTCA and IBCA (TITA)

Protecting tigers requires work on habitats, on poaching and on the relationship between wild animals and people. It focuses on restoring habitats, reducing poaching and encouraging communities to coexist with tigers. A separate effort is the NTCA Eco-Tourism Initiative, launched by the National Tiger Conservation Authority. The initiative is described as an integrated platform that offers authentic safari and accommodation bookings for visitors. Conservation of big cats also extends beyond tigers. The International Big Cat Alliance is a global initiative, and it covers several big cat species rather than only the tiger. Countries can join the alliance as ratifying members. Tiger Range Countries have also committed to a goal called TX2, which aimed to double the global wild tiger population by 2022. Global Tiger Day is observed each year by IUCN. Each of these efforts works at a different level, from habitats on the ground to international membership. Tigers are one of the big cat species, alongside lions, leopards and jaguars. The NTCA initiative and the IUCN programme cover different parts of the effort, one focused on visitors and the other on habitats and communities.

Q1.

How many big cat species does the International Big Cat Alliance cover? (number)

Answer: _____

Q2.

In which year was the International Big Cat Alliance launched? (year)

Answer: _____

Q3.

Which region does the IUCN Integrated Tiger Habitat Conservation Programme cover? (name of region)

Answer: _____

Q4.

In which city was the 1st International Big Cat Alliance Summit scheduled? (city)

Answer: _____

Q5.

In which month was the 1st International Big Cat Alliance Summit scheduled? (month)

Answer: _____

Q6.

How many initial ratifying members did the International Big Cat Alliance have? (number)

Answer: _____

Q7.

Which country leads the International Big Cat Alliance? (country)

Answer: _____

Indian Institutions and Milestones (TITA)

Wildlife protection in India rests on a set of institutions, each with a defined role. Several bodies share this work. The National Board for Wild Life is a statutory board, and its responsibilities include the promotion of conservation and development of wildlife and forests. Its legal basis lies in the Wild Life Protection Act. Project Tiger is a programme set up to support the preservation of tigers. Its tiger reserves are notified by state governments, and any change to their boundaries needs a recommendation from the National Tiger Conservation Authority and approval from the board. The authority is itself a statutory body, and it oversees Project Tiger. Population monitoring is a continuing task. The tiger population is estimated through a census cycle that repeats at fixed intervals, and more than one institution takes part in the census. One software-based system used in this area carries the name M-STrIPES, which is a monitoring system for tiger reserves. Legal and administrative steps have shaped the system over time. Changes to the wildlife law have also led to new bodies. The authority works under the environment ministry and is chaired by the minister in charge of that ministry. Tiger reserves are specially designated protected areas under Project Tiger.

Q1.

How many years does one tiger census cycle last? (number)

Answer: _____

Q2.

In which year was the Wild Life Protection Act enacted? (year)

Answer: _____

Q3.

In which year was the M-STrIPES monitoring system introduced? (year)

Answer: _____

Q4.

In which year was the export ban on all wild cat skins imposed? (year)

Answer: _____

Q5.

What is the acronym of the ministry under which the National Tiger Conservation Authority works? (acronym)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Which institute, besides the NTCA, takes part in India's tiger census? (acronym)

Answer: _____

Wetlands and Their Forms: TITA

A wetland is a place in which the land is covered by water. That water may be salt, fresh or somewhere in between. Wetlands take many forms, so the term covers a wide range of landscapes. Lakes and rivers are among the most familiar of them, and swamps and wet grasslands also count as wetlands. Along the coast, mangroves are one of the forms the booklet describes, and coral reefs and other coastal areas appear in the same list. Marshes and bogs are also listed among the forms of wetlands. Some forms sit inland, while others lie near the sea. Wet grasslands and peatlands show that the water need not always form a lake. The booklet's list of water bodies is long, and it reaches from freshwater lakes to sea-edge habitats. The common feature in the definition is that land is covered by water, rather than any single shape or size. This is why a wetland can be a large lake, a river, a swamp or a stretch of grassland. The definition therefore allows a broad range of habitats to be counted within one category. Each of these forms is still a place where the land is covered by water. The booklet presents these forms as examples of a single category, which is the wetland.

Q1.

How many segments are wetlands classified into? (number)

Answer: _____

Q2.

Name the wetland segment that is neither inland nor coastal.

Answer: _____

Q3.

Name the wetland form that the booklet lists last among its other forms (one word).

Answer: _____

Q4.

Name the underground water body that the booklet lists among wetlands (one word).

Answer: _____

Q5.

In the booklet's list of water bodies, which form comes immediately after 'Deltas' (two words)?

Answer: _____

Q6.

In the booklet's list of other forms, which form comes immediately after 'mudflats' (one word)?

Answer: _____

Q7.

In the booklet's list of other forms, which form comes immediately after 'swamps' (one word)?

Answer: _____

Ramsar Convention in Brief: TITA

The Ramsar Convention is an intergovernmental treaty that concerns wetlands. It is a formal agreement among its member countries, and it has 172 member states. The treaty focuses on wetlands of international importance. India is one of the countries that take part in the treaty. World Wetlands Day is observed every year to draw attention to wetlands and their value. Each year's observance carries a theme. The treaty takes its name from the Iranian city of Ramsar, where it was signed. The Montreux Record is a register of wetland sites. It records sites where changes in ecological character have occurred or are likely to occur. Such changes may result from technological developments, pollution or other human interference. Indian wetlands have appeared in the record. The Montreux Record is one of the tools linked to the treaty's work. Wetlands are areas of land covered by water, which may be salt, fresh or in between. The booklet describes wetlands as places with many water bodies, such as lakes, rivers and swamps. Wetlands are associated in the booklet with biodiversity and carbon stock. Wetland conservation is therefore a shared concern for the countries in the treaty.

Q1.

In which year did the Ramsar Convention come into force? (year)

Answer: _____

Q2.

In which year did India become a signatory to the Ramsar Convention? (year)

Answer: _____

Q3.

In which year was the Montreux Record launched? (year)

Answer: _____

Q4.

In the 2026 World Wetlands Day theme, which two words follow 'Celebrating'?

Answer: _____

Q5.

In which Chinese city was COP14 of the Ramsar Convention co-held in 2022? (city)

Answer: _____

Q6.

In which Swiss city was COP14 of the Ramsar Convention co-held in 2022? (city)

Answer: _____

Notable Indian achievements: short answers

The 23rd Commonwealth Games were held in Glasgow, Scotland, from 23 July to 2 August 2026, and brought athletes from many nations into one multi-sport programme. The Commonwealth Games are generally held once every four years, and the event is organised by the Commonwealth Games Federation. The idea of a Commonwealth-wide sporting competition can be traced to 1911. The booklet highlights individual athletes who produced notable performances, and it records several historic results for Indian competitors at this edition. Boxing was one of the sports in which Indian athletes performed strongly, and women boxers from India won gold medals in their events. The booklet also describes a weightlifter's results across several Games. In athletics, a javelin thrower from India took part in the men's event, returning to the Games after a gap in his participation. India's contingent also included para-athletes. The booklet presents these results in a section on India's historic achievements. The Games are contested across a range of sports, and the booklet gives its account of Indian achievements alongside the overall medal figures for the event. This edition was the one held in Glasgow in 2026, and its results are the subject of the booklet's section on Indian achievements.

Q1.

In which year did Mirabai Chanu first win a Commonwealth Games gold medal? (year)

Answer: _____

Q2.

How many women boxers from India won gold at Glasgow 2026? (number)

Answer: _____

Q3.

Who was the Indian javelin thrower who won silver at Glasgow 2026? (full name)

Answer: _____

Q4.

In which sport did Asmita Dey and Harsh Singh win India's first Commonwealth Games gold medals? (sport)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Which edition of the Commonwealth Games did Neeraj Chopra miss before returning at Glasgow 2026? (city and year)

Answer: _____

Q6.

What is the full name of the Indian boxer who won the Women's 57 kg gold at Glasgow 2026? (full name)

Answer: _____

Q7.

Across Gold Coast 2018, Birmingham 2022 and Glasgow 2026, how many Commonwealth Games gold medals did Mirabai Chanu win in total? (number)

Answer: _____

Mathematics Prize and Space Medal

Awards and science news featured among recent developments. A prestigious prize in mathematics was given to four mathematicians this year for exceptional research. The prize honours existing achievement and the promise of future work, and recipients must be younger than forty at the time of the award. Another award went to a senior astrophysics figure from India, who received a medal recognising research by scientists from developing countries. The medal is awarded every two years by a body linked to space science, and it was presented at a major international scientific assembly. The medal's name honours a founder of India's space programme. In farming news, a new popcorn maize hybrid was launched in a southern Indian state. The seed is indigenous, is not genetically modified, and was developed through a partnership between a national research institute and a company. India's maize production was reported at millions of tonnes for the 2025-26 season, and the crop is grown across several states. The prize's recipients also include mathematicians of Indian origin, honoured in earlier years. The medal was conferred on a woman scientist. Earlier recipients of the award from India were honoured in several different years, with the most recent in 2024. The COSPAR medal honours contributions to space research.

Q1.

In which year was the Fields Medal established?

Answer: _____

Q2.

Which astrophysics institute director received the 2026 COSPAR Vikram Sarabhai Medal?

Answer: _____

Q3.

In which Italian city was the 46th Scientific Assembly held, where the 2026 COSPAR medal was conferred?

Answer: _____

Q4.

Which Indian space agency co-awards the COSPAR Vikram Sarabhai Medal?

Answer: _____

Q5.

In which Indian city is the Indian Institute of Astrophysics, whose director received the 2026 medal, located?

Answer: _____

Q6.

Maize is India's third most important food crop after which two crops? (name both)

Answer: _____

Q7.

What is the scientific name of maize? (two words)

Answer: _____